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Virginia Board of Education, Work Session, Wednesday, August 27, 2025

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ql3_Azvo-ek
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:26:45] Morning. It's 9 a.m. and I will now call this meeting to order. I will note that I don't think we have anyone remotely participating today. So welcome everybody. And it's so nice to see all of your smiling faces and I'm excited to have us all together. So I want to make sure to note at the beginning of this meeting how our meeting is going to flow today, especially for our online viewers to be able to track what's happening when we are not on screen.

[00:27:16] We will begin by going into a closed session meeting so that we can consider licensure cases. The board also needs to have a closed session to receive a legal update. If we can get both of those done before about 11.15, we will do so.

[00:27:33] But at 11.15, the board will take a break to join the governor for a press conference at the Patrick Henry Building. We invite you to watch that press conference on the governor's Facebook page. When the board returns, we will either pick up with legal matters or proceed into the work session, just depending on how quickly we get our work done this morning.

[00:27:55] So, Superintendent Gullickson, do you have anything that you would like to say this morning? Thanks, President Creasy. Well, we are so excited about the momentum underway. So we encourage you to tune in around 11:15 to that event and have an action-packed afternoon for a lot of updates on the progress

our students are making. So thrilled to be at the Library of Virginia and to have our fabulous board all here in person. Okay and with that Mr. Hansen would you

[00:28:31] read our motion to go into closed session so that we can consider our licensure cases please? Yes ma'am. I move that the Virginia Board of Education convene in a closed meeting for the following purposes, discussion or consideration by the Board of Education of information relating to the denial, suspension, or revocation of teacher licenses subject to the exclusion in subdivision 11, section 2.2-3705.3, pursuant to section 2.2-3711A40 of the Code of Virginia, and consultation with counsel regarding specific legal matters requiring the provision of legal advice pursuant

[00:29:11] to Virginia Code section 2.2-37118 of the Code of Virginia. Second. Okay. Dr. Ackerman? Okay. Actually, and the legal counsel to the Virginia Board of Education staff whose presence will aid in the board's consideration of this matter participate in the closed meeting. My apologies.

[00:29:35] Dr. Ackerman? Aye. Mr. Green? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Ms. Kilgore? Mr. Monk? Chair votes aye. All right, we are in closed session now.

[00:29:50] Thank you. Okay, Mr. Hanson, would you read us out of closed session, please? And then I'll ask each board member to certify.

[02:40:58] We convene today in a closed meeting pursuant to a recorded vote on the motion above and in accordance with the Freedom Information Act section 2.2-3712 of the Code of Virginia requires that the board certify that to the best of each member's knowledge only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter and only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which selected meeting was convened or heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall so state prior to the vote indicating the substance of the departure that in his or her judgment has taken place the statement of the departure will

[02:41:37] be recorded in the minutes. Dr. Ackerman, Mr. Green, Dr. Northern, Ms. McPherson, Mr. Hanson, Ms. Kilgore, Ms. Ashton, Mr. Monk, and chair votes aye. Just as a note, again we will be going over to the Patrick Henry building as a board at this point and then when we return we will go back into closed session and we will come back on and ask Mr. Hansen to get us back into

[02:42:12] closed session. So thank you. Okay, thank you so much. We are back from the press

[04:30:16] conference and I would like to ask Mr. Hansen if he could read us into our closed meeting again. Mr. Hansen. I move that the Virginia Board of Education can be in a closed meeting for the following purposes: a discussion or consideration by the Board of Education of information relating to the denial, suspension, or revocation of teacher licenses subject to the exclusion and subdivision 11 of section 2.2-3705.3 pursuant to section 2.2-3711A40 of the Code of Virginia and consultation with

[04:30:51] legal counsel regarding specific legal matters requiring the provision of legal advice pursuant to Virginia Code section 2.2-3711A8 of the Code of Virginia and consultation with legal counsel employed by or retained by a public body regarding specific legal matters requiring the provision of legal advice by such counsel pursuant to section 2.2-37118 of the Code of Virginia and the legal counsel to the Board of Virginia, Board of Education, and staff whose presence will aid in

[04:31:26] the Board's consideration of these matters participate in the closed meeting. Dr. Ackerman? Aye. Mr. Green? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Hansen? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye.

[04:31:42] Ms. Ashton? Aye. Mr. Monk? Aye. And Chair votes aye. We are back in closed session. Thank you.

[05:34:17] Hanson, will you read us back into session, please? We convene today in a closed meeting pursuant to a recorded vote on the motion above and in accordance with the Freedom of Information Act, Section 2.2-3712 of the Code of Virginia requires that the Board certify that to the best of each member's knowledge, only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter, and only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which this closed session, this closed meeting was convened, were heard, discussed, or considered. Any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall so state prior to the vote, indicating the substance of the

[05:34:57] departure, then his or her judgment has taken place. The statement of the departure will be recorded in the minutes. Dr. Ackerman? Aye. Mr. Green? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye.

[05:35:10] Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Mr. Monk? Aye. And chair votes aye. Okay. We will get to our motions on licensure cases. In case 2025-35, the chair will entertain a motion to issue a license. So moved. Second. Dr. Ackerman? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Mr. Green? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye.

[05:35:42] Aye. Mr. Monk. Aye. Dr. Northern. Aye. Mr. Hansen. Aye. Chair votes aye. The chair will entertain a motion to deny a license to Brian Patrick Mason. Second.

[05:35:58] Dr. Ackerman. Aye. Ms. Ashton. Aye. Mr. Green. Aye. Ms. Kilgore. Aye. Ms. McPherson. Aye. Mr. Monk. Aye. Dr. Northern. Aye.

[05:36:15] case 2025-27 the case uh for revocation the chair will entertain a motion to revoke the license of anthony nicholas das i moved second dr ackerman i miss ashton mr green i miss kilgore i miss mcpherson mr monk i'm dr northern i mr hansen chair votes i in case 2025-32 the chair will

[05:36:51] entertain a motion to revoke the license of Claire Wright Mitchell. So moved. Second. Dr. Ackerman. Aye. Ms. Ashton. Aye. Mr. Green. Aye. Ms. Kilgore. Aye. Ms. McPherson. Aye. Mr. Monk. Aye. Dr. Northern. Aye. Mr. Hanson. Aye. And chair votes aye.

[05:37:11] In case 2025-31, the chair will entertain a motion to issue a license. So moved. Is there a second? Second. Dr. Ackerman. No. Ms. Ashton, Mr. Green, Ms. Kilgore, Ms. McPherson, Mr. Monk, Dr. Northern, Mr. Hanson, and chair votes aye.

[05:37:38] Okay, that concludes our cases for the day, and so we will move into Superintendent Gullickson's presentation on item A, organizational chart overview. Superintendent Gullickson.

[05:38:10] Either way, however you want to do it. All right. Well, since taking over as state superintendent has been busy listening and learning from agency staff, as well as those in the field, one of the things we know, as you heard a little bit in our last meeting, is that we are getting national recognition for things like our student chronic absenteeism reduction, cell phone free education, our readiness pathways that the

[05:38:45] Ford has championed also things like K-12 AI, as we heard last month, early childhood. And so a lot is working, but we also wanted to step back and make sure that we are really modernizing the agency

to meet the needs of students that we serve. You know that we serve from infants, our gen betas, all the way up through our adult learners with the vast majority of our students in our K-12 schools. So we really have heard both internally and externally a desire to shift from

[05:39:21] obviously maintaining our compliance focus, but really shifting more towards forward-thinking solutions and being more student-centered and really starting to streamline internal processes. We are moving ahead on collapsing a very outdated process on grants.

[05:39:43] Our COO, Christine Berto, is in the back. This is a fun project I'm working on with her around moving away from 21 different grant systems that our school divisions have to navigate across various entities and moving closer to a one-stop shop for grants so that it's even easier on our small divisions, our rural divisions, and then we have better data, collaboration, streamlines of funds, and can really see where our dollar is working for kids and where do they need improvement.

[05:40:18] So that's an example on how we're modernizing the agency to make it work better for students. And so I wanted to also focus on we're going to do a deeper dive with a public organization chart at the next meeting.

[05:40:36] So today, in order for our next speaker to make sense, I wanted to make sure to help you see some of the transformation by function as to what we're doing. And so as you look at the third slide, you can see, obviously, our learners are up at the top as our drivers, along with you, our board of ed.

[05:40:59] And we've really broken it down. Operations is now all things external and internal operations, because that just makes common sense. And that that is now our hub for all things from HR functions to budget and finance functions, technology, et cetera.

[05:41:19] One of the areas I'm really excited about that we've collapsed is moving into a branch focused on just all things academics and innovation. And that will have three core tiers or divisions within it. One on innovation, student pathways and opportunities.

[05:41:36] one where we are finally putting our teaching and learning team and our educator workforce pipeline team all under one roof of a division because it makes sense. We want to make sure that our teachers coming out of both our traditional educator prep programs and our alternative prep programs are ready to go day one and that we have a much better feedback loop with our teams on what they're needed to deliver on, like the science of reading, day one ready. So that one

[05:42:11] we're really excited about. And then our student outcomes and school quality set of functions and division. We'll have four offices, including one, if you tuned into the press conference we talked about earlier, our new office of excellence and best practices. This is also the hub for all things on student performance and metrics with assessments, both the traditional state assessments and also how can we better support the field as they embrace competency and mastery-based models

[05:42:40] like you heard today. Also, our accountability and focus on school performance and our emphasis on student and school improvement, as you've known as the Office of School Quality. And so we're really excited to have those offices logically partnering, collaborating, and all under one arm.

[05:43:06] One of the areas I'm especially excited about is merging our early learning and specialized populations teams. This is a no-brainer when you think about braiding, funding, collaboration of students' experience from birth to five team all the way up through their K-12 trajectory up to our adult learners.

[05:43:28] And so we've got three core divisions and sets of functions there from special education, early learning and our specialized populations. They obviously work in close collaboration, but important to flag that that's a critical pillar of work now and previously was disjointed and separated. And so we're excited to have them working closely together and in cross partnership across these teams. And then the last core area of functions is really around all things external partnerships. This has looked differently over the years, and so you know various functions

[05:44:07] we have from you personally on the board with board relations and other government relations experiences, as well as communications, educators, parental engagement, and all things. So I put together a few slides as just a sneak peek to what you'll see more with actual leaders and folks at the helm on the next two slides.

[05:44:32] This is the example on our Innovation Student Pathways and Opportunities Team so that you could see more clearly how those functions actually break down into a division with three core offices and some of the areas. And this really comes out a lot from our School Performance and Support Framework.

[05:44:51] When I was hearing from principals and superintendents, this is the area we're really eager about. Who's my technical expert that I speak to on this and really helping to make sure it was common sense as to where they would go for thought partnership on innovative public schools, redesign, thinking differently about space, where they would go for more than CTE, of course, is a top priority.

[05:45:18] but also we've never had someone that's fully focused on military readiness at the agency. It's obviously a core pillar here, and so making sure that we've got the right folks on staff to better support what the field has questions about and where they're looking to grow, expand programming, student experiences, and meet the board's expectations to really be ready for life.

[05:45:45] And then advanced learning merged a handful of team members that were previously across the agency now under Amanda's leadership and excited to have just a go-to spot for all things advanced coursework up through high school into college credits, early access.

[05:46:02] So the second example under operations, again, how do we make it even easier for the field to navigate? Now we will have one core hub of all functions that have to do with student supports and operations.

[05:46:18] So think of this arm of the team around external supports, transportation, school nutrition, accreditation as we move forward there, student safety, school facilities, a one-stop location.

[05:46:34] So that our folks in the field who are really hungry to think differently, have thought partnership, not just on compliance, but also how to move their school communities and student experiences forward, that they can easily navigate what those supports look like.

[05:46:51] So that's a high level on the functions. We're so grateful. The team has been diligently meeting with every office and getting feedback. What's missing? Where are gaps? Where are strengths? As we're thinking about best serving the students of 2025 and questions we're getting from the field.

[05:47:11] where are there notable gaps on things people are hungry for, and making sure that we are building that in within our existing mill to best serve students and educators in the commonwealth. So that's my quick high level, which then tees up our newest, one of our newest hires, our deputy

superintendent who oversees two of those core pillars, our student outcomes and school quality and our teaching and learning and educator workforce team. So I wanted to make sure

[05:47:45] I could help give you a quick high level as to where we're moving as an agency to best serve our students, and you'll get more next month. Are there any questions for Superintendent Gullickson on this particular presentation? Dr. Northern? Questions, but just thank you for the thoughtfulness that's been put into this. I look forward to hearing more later. But yeah, I mean, anytime you have to restructure an organization like VDOE, that's a challenge. So yeah, I appreciate the

[05:48:20] thought and the teamwork that it took to get us this far and look forward to hearing about what you guys are learning as you're reorganized, because I'm sure we'll be learning some new things. So that's great. Thank you. Okay, so we are ready for item B, trend analysis. And Ms.

[05:48:50] Booker Dwyer, if you would introduce yourself to us and give us a little bit of background as you come in. We are more than excited to have you and thank you so much. Well thank you for having me and good afternoon President Creasy and Vice President Hanson and all the board members.

[05:49:12] I am Tiara Booker-Dewire, the new Deputy Superintendent of Student Outcomes and School Quality and that title I really appreciate it because that is what I have focused my career on on ensuring that students have opportunities to and not just our lowest achieving students but all students we want to make sure that our students who are advanced continue to advance our students who are in the middle still have opportunities to grow and our lowest achievers will get the supports that they need to move up and so I have spent almost 10 years with the

[05:49:48] Maryland State Department of Education I have worked just about I feel like in every position under from a specialist all the way up to an assistant state superintendent I have been the ombudsman listening to all the concerns in education and that was the best job ever so if you ever had the opportunity to do that wonderful because it gives you a whole different perspective on the parents view of education and what they the the resources that they need to be empowered to help their students. When I was an assistant state superintendent, I was responsible for

[05:50:23] leadership development, school improvement, career and technical education, financial literacy, family and computer science, and all the other duties as assigned. So it was a great experience. I also was a part of one of the regional comprehensive centers that was funded by the U.S. Department of Education through Policy Studies and Associates, where we help to support the state's education agencies and school divisions up toward the north. So we have Maryland, D.C., Pennsylvania, New Jersey, and Delaware. And we did a lot around leadership,

[05:51:03] school improvement, and really helping to align systems and structures to meaningfully and sustainably improve student achievement. So I am so glad to be here in Virginia. I know when I was in Maryland looking at school improvement, I would always look to what Virginia was doing because, you know, as the governor mentioned, Virginia was number one. And when you were looking for, you know, models that we could bring to our state, this was a state I would look to. And so I'm so glad to finally be here and to have a wonderful team to help

[05:51:36] accelerate this work. So I had the fun job today of going over our trend analysis. So the press conference gave us a heads up of what was coming. And then this presentation is designed to go a lot deeper. And we're going to, in this presentation, it's kind of a bookend because we're going to start with the

data. We're going to talk about the support, how we're going to use data to inform support, and we're going to bookend it with, you know, proficiency scores. So this is going to be

[05:52:10] a great afternoon. And if you look on the next slide, I always like to start with level setting to ensure that we all have the same understanding of what we are talking about. And so the standards set expectations. And as a board, you have defined what students are expected to know and do through the standards of learning. And the assessments, they measure whether or not the students, did they learn it or not. And so the standards and assessment, they go hand in hand to create

[05:52:45] that clear picture of growth and achievement for students. When you go to the next slide, you will see that, you know, I get into a little more detail about how assessments are administered.

[05:53:01] They're administered at specific windows in the fall, spring, and summer. Right now, we grade the test on a scale score of 0 to 600, with 400 representing that's the minimum level of proficiency, and 500 is advanced.

[05:53:19] And students, they can retake SOL tests, and students, they must complete the required courses and pass end-of-course assessments, which are a type of SOL, um to earn their diploma. So these are um very meaningful and in high stakes tests.

[05:53:36] Uh we have different performance levels and our performance levels range from, so if you, you pass if you're at the advanced or proficient level and then um fail at basic or below basic uh for grades three to eight reading. Grades five to eight science is pass, advanced, pass proficient fail basic and then all of our other tests are past advanced past proficient or fail does not meet and so when we are presenting the the data today you'll um those are those are some terms that you will see and i wanted to start off with some good news that for the third consecutive

[05:54:15] year when you look at the overall state average for math for science for reading virginia students continue to grow. We have seen upward trends in those pass rates, and this is just a reminder that pass rates, those are the students that scored at the proficient level and advanced level. So, those numbers are combined, and those are the students that pass. So, when we talk about pass rates, we're combining proficient and advanced, and we see that our students are continuing to grow

[05:54:49] overall statewide. When we look at the reading results, and we're going to go get into a little deeper here, you have the breakdown for each grade level from 2022 to 2025. So the blue bar is 2022, orange is 2023 to 2024, and the green is 2024 to 2025. And then there's a table that lets you you know the tested count so you can get an idea if you want to do the math that would that would be

[05:55:25] on the one of the SOL tests but you could take the percentage and see approximately how many we are talking about and what you will see with the pass rates for reading is that you know it was pretty stable for grades three to five and you see that increase for grades six to eight and that is important because it lets you know that number one what our teachers what is happening in our divisions is working, and we can always get better. There's always room for growth, but we

[05:55:57] know that we at least have a baseline that we can build off of. And when you look at the different student groups on grades three to eight, what you see is you see some slight increases with the different student groups. Now, we still have a ways to go because we want to ensure that all students are performing at a high level. But what we are not seeing is a backwards trend. So we want our students to

keep moving forward and we want to accelerate that pace. And when we look at our next group of student groups, so these are our economically disadvantaged students, our English

[05:56:36] learners and our students with disabilities, the gains are relatively stable. Our economically disadvantaged students are showing a little bit more gains, but ultimately we want to bring all students up and when we look so one of the things that you're going to see from my presentations is that we have to go deeper with the data it's not enough just to show a number on the screen we want to know what division what school what teacher which students we're asking all those questions because if we have bright spots to elevate we want to elevate that and if someone needs more support we want to wrap our arms around them and give them that support so that they can be successful

[05:57:17] and so um so i was having fun looking at all the spreadsheets and the data and getting lost in that but what we are seeing is that over half of our school divisions are showing improvement and that is a really good sign some of our school divisions went down a little and we are going to make sure that we can support them and and help to ensure that they are growing in the grade three to eight reading and overall we have over 5 000 more students passed uh grades three to eight reading tests this year than they did last year. So that is very, very encouraging. We have some great

[05:57:52] divisions across this state. And just a couple of bright spots. There were 12 divisions where 80% or more of their grades, three to eight students who took the test passed. And that's huge. I was so excited to see that. I want to learn more about what they're doing. We have in nine of our divisions, 15% of their students scored at the advanced level on that grades three to eight reading SOL. And those are the divisions we want to go to and learn a little bit more so that we

[05:58:28] can increase that rate. And then we had school divisions with some significant improvement. There were seven where their pass rates improved by 8% or more from last year to this year. Those are also divisions we want to learn from because to get that kind of growth in one year is um it is just wonderful we have our end of course reading uh assessment and so you'll see that our grade 9 through 12 students in the tested count for each year and we saw growth over 85 percent of our

[05:59:05] students who took that exam uh passed it for the 2024-2025 school year when we look at our math results what we see is that once again that there was improvement across all grade bands for grades three through eight that overall there was improvement and when we look and this translated into the different racial ethnic groups where there was improvement there too in math so we're doing something in math here that's very exciting and we are going to double down on that

[05:59:43] and put more funding behind that and really make sure that our kids are are continuing to excel and you saw um some some of those strong gains as well for our economically disadvantaged english learners and students with disabilities but once again these gains we want to ensure we're not saying that you know having a 39.4 percent pass rate is acceptable for us we want all of our students to to move up so we um we recognize that there are that there is still more work to do what was truly exciting is when we looked and did a little deeper dive into the

[06:00:20] divisions that improve student math performance in grades three to eight we saw over 75 percent of our school divisions improved in math for grades three to eight we had um 24 a little over 24 that that dropped and um a little over 8 000 students that uh 8 000 more students passed their grades three to eight slo this year what last the 2024 2025 school year compared to the previous year and some bright spots um that that was that we saw looking at the data was that um 12 divisions

[06:01:00] had more than 80 percent of their students pass and so this is another thing that we really want to to look at. More than 15% of students scored at the advanced level in four divisions, and we had three school divisions that had pass rates that had showed some significant improvement. When we look at the statewide geometry and Algebra II SOL pass rates, I mean, you can see those tested counts. We saw improvement there as well, and you can see the number, and you can see those tested

[06:01:38] counts and what's really exciting is that we have a lot of middle school students that are taking advantage of taking those harder level math courses earlier and um and so you can look at the numbers for grades six through 12 and um and you'll see that at that middle school level those students are taking it was about 55 000 students took that end of course assessment um in middle school so these numbers are very encouraging when we go to science and we look at the pass rate for science

[06:02:17] so our grade we have a grade five and grade eight science assessments and once again you see that increase in pass rates for grade five and grade eight once again for the third consecutive year so we are trending in the right direction and when we look at the all the different student groups you'll see that there's some modest increase and we you know we can always do better and provide additional support to make sure those students are truly meeting that benchmark and when we look at

[06:02:53] the statewide end of course assessment for science and this is for earth science biology and chemistry we will see that the the pass rates there had they have also improved so overall we're seeing those trends moving forward. And then this next batch of data that I want to show you is going to be around the Virginia studies, civics, economics, history, and writing SOL results. And what we saw with the Virginia studies and the civics and economics is that you'll see that the number

[06:03:30] of students that, well, that tested count is declining, and that the number of students that passed or the pass rates have also declined as well and so that is something that we want to look into but we know we can see and you're going to see some of this is that you know once you start to have a lot of assessments and students have choices then they can take different assessments and so everyone may not take every single one of these assessments that i'm going to show you as i go through and what we see is that um that the the virginia on the next slide is that the

[06:04:10] Virginia study SOL pass rates, it pretty much held steady across student groups. And you saw on the next, and you can see on the next slide that for the civics and economics SOL tests, that there were the students with disabilities had a slight increase in their pass rate compared to the other student groups. For the end of course history social science SOL tests, so you have world history

[06:04:42] one and two uh virginian u.s history uh and so you have you see the tested counts and um for the most part it there were some slight increases but once again when you look at the tested count the numbers are starting to get low lower and for the end of course writing sol tests um they pretty much remain consistent across all three years um but once again you look at those tested count numbers uh that you you know you have more more robust numbers in the earlier grades and so we're

[06:05:19] not stopping here so for this presentation you got the big picture for pass rates for all the different sols how to get a snapshot of how students are doing across the state at the grade for different grade levels but we are not going to stop there so right now what we are doing is going a lot deeper into the data and that's going to inform the support we provide to school divisions through professional learning so it won't just be we're not just randomly picking professional learning topics we want to use the data to

inform that when we are talking about high quality instructional materials that improve student achievement we're going to give more

[06:05:56] statewide support on that and we want to give that really tailored and personalized support to our divisions that need it most and we're going to use data to be that driver we are in the process of developing a whole toolkit to support families teachers leaders and um and all educators just understanding how to use the assessments what these assessment scores mean we want to ensure that we have consistency in the language so everyone is is saying the same understands when we're using certain terminology there's consistency in that understanding

[06:06:36] and ways to support students both in school and at home and so that will be coming shortly and our next steps is we're going deeper with the data we're going we want to pinpoint specific areas specific content and skills that we can go deeper on and um and what's coming up next so this is just part one pass rates are that's your appetizer but the main course is coming in September so in September is when we are going to you'll start to see more around that school performance and support framework we are going to share the results and we're going to go a lot

[06:07:13] deeper into the different framework categories federal identification accreditation designation and so this is just your appetizer we are going to have a whole meal in September around this data and accountability. And with that, I will open the floor for any questions. Anybody have questions?

[06:07:35] First of all, this is really exciting, all the improvements. I mean, you're just coming in at such a neat time to really dig into the data. This is more just a comment and maybe kind of for future file away reference, but when you're talking about being able to relate all the data down to the teacher, it would be neat to relate it even down to the university that trained the teacher. So, I mean, I'm sure we have some probably bright spots in certain subject areas and certain spots that we can learn from each other. So as you're creating the data, just throwing that idea out there. Oh, you must have been in my meeting yesterday with the assistant super educator prep programs, because that's exactly what we were talking about. How can we make all these data

[06:08:14] systems talk to each other so that we could truly see, and I've, you know, there's other states, there's a state right now that will hold educator prep programs accountable if the teacher doesn't pass the, if their, their sparring teacher doesn't pass the, the assessment to get their license. And I don't know if we want to go that far, but you know, there are educator prep programs that are doing some great things that we need to know about, and they're producing some great educators. And there are educator prep programs that we could support more to ensure that they are meeting the needs of our students. And so I would, that is something we are actively talking

[06:08:49] about. Good stuff though. Other comments or questions, Dr. Northern? Welcome. First of all, we're very happy to have you. I'm wondering on slide 29 for the student pass rates on the EOC writing SOL, are the kids who take the ACT work keys business writing included in that, or are they separate? No, that would be separate. So this is just, and I want to look, and I want to make sure I'm speaking the right thing, so I have some team members out here, so if I'm not, let me know.

[06:09:20] So this is what's happening here. These are just the students who took the end of course writing that the state administers. Okay. Can we in a future, not any big hurry, can we actually get a read on how many kids are taking the ACT work keys as a substitute for our EOC writing SOL test?

[06:09:40] And I'll go ahead and put my cards on the table, is that I've heard repeatedly that it is a far cry from the EOC writing SOL test. And I think if kids fail our EOC writing test and they're given the opportunity to get a verified credit for graduation through the ACT workkeys. I think that's our policy, but just would love to hear how many kids are having to take that option and whether we think that it looks about right or whether we still think, like, maybe we need to revisit that policy. Thank you. Oh, and I got to see, look, my backup came right in time,

[06:10:17] and so, and so, yeah, so if there's any questions, let me know. Yes, more of just a statement, Again, welcome. But the toolkits that you're providing for divisions, super powerful, excited to see that and see expansion upon that. And then from the lens of school board members as well, excited to see some resources that can equip maybe members who aren't versed in education to kind of know what to look for within their own locality. So thank you for the creation of these and what I'm sure is to come. Yes. And I didn't mention that I was a school board member.

[06:10:56] And so having those type of resources, it's just so helpful. So yes, we will have a lens on school boards and how we can support them and what questions you should ask and what does this mean? And we want to make sure we do provide that support.

[06:11:13] Others. Yeah. I guess it's more of a, excuse me, first of all, welcome. Welcome to Virginia. We're glad you're here. We're glad you're in your current role. Because there is a, you mentioned in your, I think you mentioned in your presentation on what I read, excuse me, that there are a lot of CISI schools, I think that's the correct terminology, and because some school divisions have a greater proportion of CSIs than other school divisions, many of which have these memos of understanding MOUs between the BDOE

[06:11:51] and your local school divisions for the ultimate purpose of improving student performance, especially in some of those subgroup areas that you reference during your presentation. Look forward to working with you in that regard in terms of what's in those MOUs, as well as the actual supports that will align to help give those school divisions support they need so that we can improve academic performance in those school divisions.

[06:12:21] So you have previewed my second presentation. That is what we're going to talk about. We are going to go through those MOUs. We want to sit down with those division superintendents. We know we have a new accountability, accreditation. So we really do need to revisit MOU schools and make sure that we are doing what's best for that school division, because some of them are showing some pretty good gains.

[06:12:44] And so let's look to see if the MOU is still needed. What do we need to do? How can we tweak it? So, yes, that is coming up. Awesome. Other questions or comments? Ms. McPherson? Yeah. Certainly. Thank you for your presentation. Very well done and welcome. And we're really excited about having you.

[06:13:06] As we move forward, I like a lot of drill down statistics, and it's not necessarily something that always has to be done on a, you know, very public forum. But as you talked about the combination of proficiency and advanced learners, I think at some point we should break that out so that we can determine whether or not the percentages are skewed any at all by those that are advanced learners in terms of our proficiency numbers.

[06:13:37] I'd be interested in that. And also, as we look at funding, I've been very clear and big about the fact that I want to make sure that in the places where we do need additional funding for those students

that are attempting to improve and that are actually lagging the percentage increase in achievement, that we're making sure that we are driving the funds there.

[06:14:05] So at some point as we move along, I'd like to see where we put funding as it relates to the economically disadvantaged students, the English learners, the Hispanic population, just so we can make sure that I'm understanding that the resources are actually tracking what the percentages are.

[06:14:26] And I know you guys are doing a really great job as far as that's concerned, but I think it's going to be as far as the public's concerned and the board is concerned, the parents are concerned that we're actually looking at where the support is. Yes, I love that. And that is something we have talked about.

[06:14:42] And, you know, to double down on that, we've even we're even talking about the return on investment. Like if we're putting, you know, taxpayers need to know Virginia gives a lot of money to school divisions. I mean, I came here and I'm like, wow, there is so much money in the bank. Are you getting a return on investment, especially when we're talking about school improvement?

[06:15:01] And so that we're beginning to set those systems up, especially with the way that we're redesigning some of our grant applications to build that into the application up front and make it explicit to compel the division to, you know, you have to do that.

[06:15:18] And then we're aligning the monitoring process to that. So we are working through that now because there's a lot of money, a lot of good taxpayer dollars, and we want to make sure that they're getting a return. Do you have any idea what's behind these lower tested counts on slide 28?

[06:15:38] So in 2022, we've gone from half the number of kids taking World History 2, for instance, from 14,000 to seven in two years. And I'm just wondering, is that just, you know, enrollment loss?

[06:15:53] because i know that's happening everywhere including in virginia or is there something else going on behind some of these decreases and so a lot of it is they have options and i don't know if mr ellis you want to talk a little bit about the so he is our he leads our assessment team um doing a wonderful wonderful job all things assessment he knows come on up good afternoon jason ellis the director of the office of assessment so the change could be from many factors one students only need one verified credit to meet graduation requirements that

[06:16:30] probably weighs pretty strong in that number that started in 1819 so as students kind of have moved on through the you know through the the process of schooling at high school we may have seen the drop off as a result of students moving excuse me moving out of that i think it also could be that they may be looking at other areas to try to earn that verified credit world geography world history or even some divisions may be using Virginia and U.S. history or Virginia U.S. government as a way to earn that verified credit.

[06:17:03] So I think it could just be course-taking patterns as much as anything else. I don't think necessarily it's an enrollment issue. I just think there could be other things at play. Thank you. Sure. Why don't you fall? Ms. McPherson. And this is off your slides altogether, but I just need to know, as far as the writing is concerned, do we have an educational component for cursive writing?

[06:17:29] Yes, we added it. So it is in the standards. In elementary school, I want to say there is a cursive, right? There are cursive writing standards. Yeah, because some of the latest data is demonstrating that as

far as self-esteem and improvement, the students that really don't know how to write in cursive are having a really difficult time progressing.

[06:17:53] And it may be something that we want to look at, putting more of an emphasis on. It's been a lot of new data out there relative to that. Thank you so much, Ms. McPherson. Our former board member, Dale Sturdefin, was a staunch advocate. And had you been a part of this board during his tenure, you too would know what a staunch advocate Mr. Sturdefin was for that. And so that leads us to those exact things that you are bringing up today and certainly will be part of the work moving forward in that particular topic.

[06:18:27] all right thank you so much anybody else thank you very much thank you okay and so now we are moving to item c do we need to give any time for setup on this one do we know no no okay um so this is our national expert series this is the uva partnership for leaders in education featuring danville public schools um first our presentation is a part of this series we will hear from William Robinson, the Executive Director of the University of Virginia's Partnership for Leaders

[06:19:05] in Education. UVA-PLE is the leading national organization increasing the capacity of K-12 teams to create conditions where all schools can thrive and achieve enduring improvements in student learning, particularly for underserved youth. During his 12 years as Executive Director, the PLE has launched nationally leading services, frameworks, and research in school system transformation and served 33 states. Under Robinson's leadership, UVAPLE became recognized by the Wallace Foundation and RAND as the only remaining K-12 leadership development organization

[06:19:44] in the country, with peer-reviewed articles demonstrating impact on growing student learning results. Robinson was recognized in District Administration's inaugural 2024 list for the 100 most influential leaders in education and ignited PLE to recognition during 24-25 and featured articles in the 74 million, K-12 Dive, Education Week, and the Hechinger Report. Robinson's passion for education stems from growing up in Arkansas Delta and observing how education systems fall

[06:20:18] short in advancing opportunity. He's a graduate of Harvard, Center for Better Schools, and Stanford Children. I'm sorry, he's a graduate of Harvard Business School. I'm getting all my stuff mixed up today. Sorry. My glasses aren't working right. Princeton University, an alum of Education Pioneers and a past advisor to Communities in Schools and Achievement Network. Thank you so much for being with us today. Thank you, President Creasy, for having me. Thank you, Dr. Booker-Dreyer, for setting this up. Thank you, Superintendent Gullickson, for having us

[06:20:54] and the entire board this is an exciting moment for the state of Virginia with the rollout of the school performance and support framework thank you for shining a light a greater light on where students are and what it's going to take for us to support divisions to accelerating the opportunities and learning that our students deserve with your investment and your team's investment in high quality instructional materials early literacy this framework and many other things building on the three years of increasing pass rates it's time to accelerate that to another level particularly

[06:21:29] for our most underserved students as Dr. Booker Dwyer said there is still more work to be done and what will it take to accelerate to the next level because in part because Virginia by many metrics lost more ground in any other state from 2019 to 2022 in indicators like NAEP there are places where Virginia is below the national average and there are over half of our Black and Hispanic students below basic at the eighth grade level in mathematics. And these things are

[06:22:05] unacceptable and it is incredible to imagine what's possible building on these frameworks. Our organization, the University of Virginia Partnership for Leaders in Education, we are a partnership between the Darden School of Business and the University of Virginia School of Education in human development. And our laser-like focus, as you're increasing the laser-like focus divisions across Virginia, is on raising educational outcomes at that student school and system level so that we can make a difference at scale and quickly in changing the trajectory and providing opportunities students deserve. This presentation will end after your Q&A with an incredible

[06:22:45] opportunity for Danville to tell their story. It's an incredible group of leaders who made incredible progress both before our partnership and continue to and my hope is that in speaking about our lessons learned in our model it could help inform a broader partnership and support model across the state so in terms of the next slide our focus specifically is on first how do we provide transformational learning experiences not to individuals but to teams to help them

[06:23:23] identify and confront their most pressing challenges for enhancing student learning and creating conditions where that can happen. Our executive education at the University of Virginia is often ranked number one in the world for change management and general leadership and it was designed 22 years ago in part because of the state of Virginia's investment to be brought two leaders doing the most important work imaginable are educators. And no matter how great those transformational learning experiences are, how can that be coupled with thought partnership and support in the field on an ongoing basis to help those leaders make those commitments and

[06:24:03] their dreams that they articulate and the improvements that they articulate come alive? As you talked about with your expert series last month, high quality instruction materials are incredibly important. And you see wide variability in the implementation and whether that's making a difference for students. And we would argue that it's about both the systems and the shared leadership and how collective leaders work together across silos to make those materials and supports make a difference for their teachers. Our team, I have two members here, Kobe Myers, he's our chief of research and a professor at the School of Education,

[06:24:42] Dr. LaToya Harrison is one of our district support chiefs who rolls up their sleeves and works alongside systems across the country to make their aspirations come alive.

[06:24:58] Our work was founded in Virginia. This is cohort 22 we're on now. Cohorts one and two were only Virginia divisions and schools and was originally called the School Turnaround Specialist Program. It was largely funded by the VDOE, and that seed resulted in 22 years of growth with our largest cohort ever this year.

[06:25:25] What we found over time is that although those investments that started with a turnaround and school leader focus could make a difference in significantly raising achievement in a short time, for that work to be enduring, for that work to affect schools across divisions, it's got to be systemic.

[06:25:45] We can't just invest in schools school by school, but how do we create conditions in which schools thrive? That doesn't mean top-down change. It means collectively owned change. And so we work with teams to move the work for at least two and a half years because the work is messy and comprehensive.

[06:26:04] And change research across industry shows it takes five to seven years for change to truly stick. And so we want to start our partnership with a multi-year effort that actually rolls up our sleeves and learns from teachers and students what's working, what's not, so that we can work with that data and with division leaders and school principals to figure out what to do. So on the next slide, we speak to what I've already spoke to a little bit, which is this combination. We've got to make investments in school leaders.

[06:26:35] Ultimately, teachers and leaders are obviously the heart of improving student achievement, And we don't have leaders across the Commonwealth and across the country that are completely ready to lead transformation without support from others, whether that's from their state, from their division, from partners like us.

[06:26:57] But what we do know is that transformational leadership can be built, particularly with people with the belief that what all students can do and the dedication to learning and deliberate practice.

[06:27:08] And we know that those school leadership investments are going to be more successful when there's collective ownership and accountability, where it's not about division setting up school leaders to sink or swim, but ultimately the division leaders and the school leadership teams together are owning, here's how we're going to improve and here's what we're committed to, and being transparent about that, which is more likely in a world with a school performance and support framework.

[06:27:38] So our work focuses on those teams and that collective ownership. The next slide speaks to the other thing we seek to balance, which is research-based practices. We know that for the work to accelerate, we want to drill down on both at that school level and at that system level, what research says matters for conditions that lead to student success.

[06:28:00] And we know it can't be formulaic. We know, as Dr. Booker-Dryer talked about before, it's got to be differentiated and personalized for that division, for that school. And how you do that, that combination of combining, helping system leaders and school leaders understand where their practices are against research-based practices, and figuring out what to prioritize based on their vision, based on their data, based on where they are in their journey, that local context matters tremendously.

[06:28:30] If you go to the next slide, one other kind of lesson learned about our partnership and a focus of ours through the years is increasingly this learning lab focus. It is possible to improve an entire division at once, and there are certain practices that make sense to go division-wide at once, but in any type of innovation, prioritizing a set of schools, a set of focus areas, and going deep in those with a set of schools, what it takes engaging change agents at the teacher and administrator level to co-create

[06:29:08] what it's going to take helps generate not only improvement in practice but lessons learned systems that can scale across the division as divisions like danville are doing right now and so what i'm what i'm here to say on the next slide is that dramatic change is possible transformation is possible. Schools that are on that CSI list have no reason to be on that CSI list five years from now. We can lift all boats, and focusing on our most underserved schools and underperforming places is the place to start and catalyze system-wide change,

[06:29:47] and that we see it across geography. We see it in rural areas, urban areas, suburban areas across the country. In the introduction, they talked about the study of strong evidence of student impact based on two peer-reviewed journal articles and in the stories that are listed right here. Stories like Fond du Lac, Wisconsin that had a superintendent and leadership team willing to invest in the science of

reading, willing to invest in amplifying their underperformance and saying it was unacceptable. And ultimately, just in a span of three years, going from near

[06:30:21] the bottom of all divisions in Wisconsin in performance in ELA and math to a systemic effort that leads them to being above average in the state of Wisconsin just three years later. In divisions like Charleston that have increased accountability coming from the state of South Carolina paired with investments in high quality instruction materials and in leadership where they're one of the only urban divisions in the entire country just recognized in a Harvard study last year as above their 2019 levels in every single grade level in ELA and in math and many

[06:30:57] schools having 25 point plus improvements. So we know that this is possible. We know that this work can be done systemically and that Virginia is poised to do it with more deliberate focus on how are we going to leverage this performance framework to provide the support that our our division leaders need to raise performance and be transparent about that. We also see this in Virginia. We were fortunate that the VDOE invested in a pilot for us to work with two

[06:31:30] divisions. One of those divisions, Danville Public Schools, as I mentioned earlier, and they'll tell more about their incredible story when I'm done, they had already done a lot of work

[06:31:43] to set the foundation for where they're going before our partnership under the leadership of Superintendent Harrison, that student centered focus on transparency on student data and a data driven focus of where we're going and an embrace of some of what's come out of BDOE in terms of high quality instruction materials, early literacy playbooks, in terms of Dr. Babalola and the team really getting a lot of instructional infrastructure in place that was more focuses more on how we're actually going to improve

[06:32:13] improve pedagogy professional development support driven by where students are. And then pairing that with our opportunity to partner with them in three schools and in their team and invest in leadership. You see not only on this slide, the tremendous gains in place like Bonner where you're going to hear from soon that moved off of that CSI list that in last year had a 10 point rise in reading and a 20 point rise in math. But then you see in the data that came out today, another nine point gains this past year in math, another five point gains this past year in reading.

[06:32:49] You see Schoolfield Elementary and Westwood both make gains again this year, and so we'll we'll talk more importantly they'll share more about their story and what they did to move that forward. We also had the opportunity to partner with Nottaway Public Schools where they this past year had four of their five partnership schools have double-digit gains in mathematics. Two of those five have double-digit gains in language arts, have last year their graduation and completion

[06:33:22] rate indicator go from 83.7 to 91.5. In a previous partnership last decade, because we had not partnered with Virginia Divisions for the better part of a decade until these two pilots, we've got got to partner with Smith County, where Ridge Valley became one of nine highly distinguished schools in the state, and Marion Elementary drew from barely accredited to distinguish. And you see that in some of the examples on the other page. It's not just about getting off a list. It's about lifting opportunity in some of these schools, becoming exemplar or blue ribbon schools to inform

[06:33:58] the state and what's possible. So what are these leaders, leaders like the leaders in Danville doing that's leading to that achievement. If you go to the next slide, what we've learned through our research and experience is to focus both on those technical conditions. What are, we talk about four levers

in systems leadership, support and accountability to grow school leadership, team practice, talent management, instructional infrastructure. Again, not top-down change, but we're going to have co-created change that creates the conditions for schools, teachers, principles to thrive, what are those conditions that leaders co-create across the system to make

[06:34:35] that possible? We would argue it's these four, but just like you talked about last month with HQIM, it can't just be dropped in. There's got to be adaptive leadership that makes it come alive. Being a school leader is incredibly hard, so how can we build their change leadership capacity to reimagine the system to be more responsive to students, to build collective ownership in their own networks, both in their community and their schools, swimming in the same direction, using 90 plans to capture learning and continue cycles improvement as they go. On the next slide gives a

[06:35:12] little bit of summary of where our partnership focuses. We talked a little bit about those transformational learning experiences that anchor to provide teams that time away from their school divisions and schools and the busy lives they lead to really dive into what's most important to change in their communities, that ongoing support that we are so fortunate to get to provide them.

[06:35:34] But before that even ever starts is that this personalization, this design and launch phase to help system leaders based on the voices of their teachers and their data and their students and their other people in their district articulate here's where we most need to go. Here's what we most need to improve about our system conditions and how we're going to use a learning lab of schools to get there. And then along the way, while we're still focused on adaptive change, we also need to focus on essentials. So we're making sure every single partner that we are fortunate to partner with is having a plan to drive focus in their schools, is being exposed

[06:36:11] to support in data-driven instruction, data cycles, and acceleration to make sure that we're lifting expectations and models for what all students can achieve, and then customizing within that based on where that division is. In that next slide it gives a rough summary of the services that we provide across the partnership knowing that that's just a foundation and we ultimately we and many other of the partners that are seeing results across the country customize those supports with tailored supports along the way based on where the divisions are. If you go to the next

[06:36:50] slide it gives a further summary of what those key levers are and I just want to give some examples of how this comes alive differently in different places in these four letters. So the first story on the next slide is Winston-Salem. So Winston-Salem School District from 2021 to 2024, we worked with their 13 most underperforming schools and 10 of the 13 schools far exceeded their state growth targets and five experienced at least 20 point proficiency gains.

[06:37:20] So what did they do? Well, in that division, they already had a partnership in talent management to really hone in on different university partnerships and different ways of enhancing their teacher and leadership pipelines. So they didn't really need our support with that. That's what was moving.

[06:37:36] But what they needed help with was connecting those investments to a systemic approach, connecting those investments to more coordinated hands-on supervision that's growing the practices of those pipeline of leaders, to more tiered supports that are responsive to where the schools actually are to more focus on those 90 plans and how they're being used to get data cycles connected to high quality instruction materials so they're not done in in isolation but we're combining the implementation of high

quality curriculum with high quality data-driven instruction that's what winston-salem focused on in our partnership which is different than what

[06:38:15] danville public schools focus on pressure they'll tell more again about what they focused on but again, they already had a lot of strong work moving around their focus on literacy frameworks, movement towards more time and greater focus in their PLCs, HQIM. We've had the opportunity to get to partner with them on establishing tight, loose expectations for schools and figuring out how they're co-creating and making those systems come alive and building their leadership practices to making it happen in helping them with the adaptive leadership and 90 plans to make that

[06:38:53] student-centered culture come alive. And so what I'll leave you with before any Q&A is two slides that really try to scale back out outside of just a summary of our model and approach towards what we see across the country. So number one, this combination of accountability and transparency, what your state which the state is moving towards with an investment in capacity building and that investment capacity building looks different in four divisions and schools and we would argue

[06:39:31] investing more in places that are the coalition of the willing that are making bold commitments to a significant improvement and to doing what it's going to take can really lead lend to that strong return on investment and strong sustained improvement that prioritize talent ultimately that we see in underperforming schools across the country that a need for a differentiated approach to talent ultimately these schools often have the the teachers who are more junior less

[06:40:05] likely to the conditions are not where they're often attracting teachers who have a history of results for students. And although we have to have approaches that build the capacity of teachers to do it, we also want to make sure that these are not the schools that are more likely to have openings, which is often the case. That we are investing in teacher leaders and others who make it where this is the place where teachers grow and become excellent in performance and those hard to staff positions are filled so that you can also attract principals. Because principals

[06:40:41] want to be a part of this when there is focus, when there is support that's aligned to their needs. And oftentimes state support at its best deepens focus because there's efforts to ensure that support system is connected to the planning of the district where there's alignment on what we're focusing on. Too often across the country, we see state support results in a lack of alignment and incoherence because what the state is focusing on is completely different than what the division leaders are focusing on. It's completely different than what the school leaders are focused on and and maybe different than what the teachers are focused on. Great support helps build capacity and

[06:41:19] adaptive communication towards having alignment of support so that we can co-create and drill down and truly make a difference. And then the final slide is just to say that enduring change is incredibly possible and is happening across the country. We, 80 percent of our partners extend that partnership after the first two and a half years. It's often initially funded by philanthropic dollars or state dollars but then it's extended by the often the district dollars because they're seeing the results places like Boulder Valley in Colorado where when the partnership started they had multiple

[06:41:56] schools on the state list a decade later none on that state list and ultimately far outperforming where demographics would lead you to predict them to be in that state in Fulton County started with 29 F schools moved to three over time and has continued to see those rises in student achievement. What it

takes is a systemic focus, a deliberate practice to ensure that we do not accept underperformance and that we invest in the Coalition of the Willing and that we hold a high bar for what all of our students

[06:42:30] can do because when we do, they rise to it. And I'm so excited about this opportunity for the state of Virginia to get right for our students the education they deserve because they're going to rise to it as we take that systemic approach. Thank you. Not so much a question, but more so I share your sentiments that the goal should be to reduce as much as possible the list of schools

[06:43:01] that are categorized as CSI schools. Excuse me again. Did you mention that Danville Public Schools and not a way county schools are the two pilot schools. They were the two pilot divisions that BDOE helped fund us to work with the last two years.

[06:43:21] Gotcha.

[06:43:30] Okay, thank you so much. And so our next presentation will be Dr. Angela Hairston. Dr. Hairston is a native of Southside, Virginia, and received her secondary education from the Pennsylvania school system. She received a bachelor's degree in mathematics and business management from Averick College and began her career in education in Halifax County and Virginia Beach school systems before returning to Danville to teach mathematics at George Washington High School. Dr. Hairston later served as the principal of Westwood Middle School. She continued her education, earning a master's degree in secondary school administration from Hampton University and a doctorate in educational

[06:44:08] leadership from Virginia Tech. She continued her career in the state of Georgia, serving as director of Human Resources, a principal, an assistant principal for the Gwinnett County Public Schools, and as a regional superintendent and principal for the DeKalb County School District, and as a superintendent in the Augusta-Richmond County, Georgia, and North Carolina. In 2018, Dr. Harrison was selected to participate in the prestigious and nationally recognized Broad Superintendent's Academy, and we are so excited to have her here today. Thank you. Thank you so much.

[06:44:44] Thank you. I'm President Creasy, Vice President Hanson, Superintendent Gulickson, and our esteemed board members here today. And thank you so much. And welcome to Virginia, Ms. Booker Dwyer. Hopefully we can. So do you all have the presentation? Okay. All right.

[06:45:02] So thank you again for an opportunity to present. I'm joined here today by our Chief Academic Officer, Kiwi Babalola, Dr. Babalola, Ms. Joellen Hilton, our Chief of Schools, Kim Agner, our Director of Curriculum and Instruction, and Wayne Mayo, our Principal Extraordinaire, okay? So to begin with, I wanted to just talk a little bit about our district so you have some context and a little bit about what drove us to really focus on improving education and the changes that we have made. Slide two will tell you a little bit about who we are.

[06:45:36] Now, I know when you hear Danville, you're thinking about the casino. We're more than the casino, okay? Danville is an independent city located in Southern Virginia along the Dan River, just north of North Carolina. As of 2025, the estimated population was 41,000 residents, often referred to as the city of churches.

[06:46:00] Danville has a rich historical and cultural legacy. It served as the last capital of the Confederacy, and today its River District stands as a symbol of revitalization. We're proudly known as the Comeback City. If you visit with us, you'll see a lot of the tobacco warehouses or now apartments.

[06:46:21] You'll see an emphasis on economic growth and a strategic plan to improve transportation. The next slide tells a little bit about our population. We serve 5,600 students, 69% African-American, 15% Caucasian, and 12% Hispanic.

[06:46:38] We have 383 English language learners, and 80% of our students are on free or reduced lunch. Hence, we are what's termed as a CEP district, so all of our students receive free breakfast and free lunch. And it's pretty good, by the way. We do emphasize quality, okay?

[06:46:55] And so these slides sort of give you a little bit of information about our students because it drives our work. It drives the essentials of our work, the strategies we use to educate our students. On the next slide, you'll learn that we have 13 schools, 10 choice programs.

[06:47:15] So our students do apply for various choice programs. We believe in choice. We have 450 teachers. We serve our students through a traditional high school, an alternative school, two middle schools, six elementary schools, a magnet IB school.

[06:47:33] We also have a STEM academy that is grades 3-7. We have a virtual academy. We also have pathways that children can apply to or participate in, including an aviation pathway, medical pathway. Our elementary students participate in a cyber community academy. And so lots of opportunity for diverse learning for our children. And again, I mentioned that we are 100% free breakfast and lunch, and it does matter. Nutrition matters.

[06:48:05] On the next slide, a little bit about why. When I assumed the role of superintendent in December 2020, I did come from Winston-Salem Forsyth, so we started the partnership with UVA PLA and Winston-Salem Forsyth. I assumed this role because it was my hometown and I understood that there was a need there for instructional leadership. We began there. The memorandum of understanding with the Virginia Department of Education was already in place. The board had actually gladly signed it

[06:48:40] because there had been years of declining student achievement. And along with that, we had a corrective action plan, or we call it the cap, the 28-page cap. While it addressed the immediate instructional needs, we knew there was a broader need for a strategic framework.

[06:48:58] So in January 2021, our school board approved a partnership with Virginia School Boards Association to develop a strategic plan. The strategic plan was really to uplift the community voice, the voice of students and teachers and the folks boots on the ground to really get some understanding about how we were going to proceed. We crosswalked that plan with the CAP, the Corrective Action Plan, because that is and continues to be important work to create our bold roadmap for change. And so on the next page, you'll see that our strategic plan

[06:49:38] did require us to engage in bold transformation. And transformation is tough sometimes because, you know, people, when they hire you, they say, well, we want change. They really don't know that they're the ones that need to change. And I'm understanding that part. So the change is tough.

[06:49:55] Change is tough. And so we were able to use our resources, leverage our relationships, and engage in that change. Our core business on the next page, our strategic map, our theory of change was very simple in terms.

[06:50:15] It begins with improving school culture and climate that leads to stronger stakeholder engagement and increased professional growth opportunities. In turn, this strengthens our internal

systems and operations which ultimately resulted in improved student achievement.

[06:50:34] And these are not short-term fixes. These are fixes that are long-term. And what we cannot do is believe that student achievement is made better just by writing better lesson plans. There's a structure that must exist to lift up our student achievement.

[06:50:51] So on the next page, you'll find that we had some big rocks. Now, I could spend a lot of time, and I'm going to leave you, if it's okay, Superintendent Gulickson, with a strategic plan. I could spend a lot of time speaking about aspects of our strategic plan. There were three big rocks that I want to leave you with.

[06:51:07] First was regarding leadership. We prioritized developing strong, empowered school leaders that knew how to focus on instruction. That is incredibly important in your schoolhouse. Real-time accountability paired with time support, empowering our principals to lead for change.

[06:51:28] We were just having a dialogue with Mr. May about algebra one for all. So we debate, you know, our instructional framework, but ultimately we do empower our principals to make those decisions. Clear and actual school level planning. So we partner with the VDOE and the Office of School Quality to really help our principals understand the comprehensive needs assessment process.

[06:51:51] It wasn't just getting the test scores and rolling over to the next year. It was really taking the summer to have a comprehensive needs assessment and then writing a good plan that will be reviewed as mentioned by Dr. Robinson every 90 days, something that we look at quite frequently. So our partnership with the UVA PLE has been pivotal in ensuring that we have another set of eyes and a framework for improving leadership. Leadership matters and you cannot rise above the building leadership. So we engage in our leaders, we invest in our leaders, and we believe

[06:52:30] in our leaders. The next big rock had to do with curriculum and student achievement on the next slide there. One of our biggest barriers was actually teaching a consistent and consistent and coherent curriculum, really having the pacing guides, the resources, the tools that teachers needed to write good lessons. That was something that we really saw as a barrier, and we've been able with Dr. Babalola's support and her team's support to really spend time with teachers. But

[06:53:04] it wasn't just us writing and sending it out. We invested in having our teachers be a part of writing our local curriculum, which is based on the SOLs, by the way. We don't want to leave that part out, right? And today, we have a vertically aligned, coherent curriculum rooted in standards and supported by high-quality instructional materials. That was the other important piece, the high-quality instructional materials because, you know, you can have standards, and if teachers use materials that are low in rigor, you're not going to see the gains that you want to see.

[06:53:38] We also had to invest in our data-driven instructional mindset. You have to be able to have access to data, not just formative data or summative data that we look at with the results we just received, which we're real excited about the results that we've received and the growth we continue to have.

[06:53:59] But you have to be able to see the formative assessment data, look at attendance data. How are your EL students doing on the benchmarks? These are types of data sets that we look at throughout the year. And we have a mindset and a framework in our district that helps us out with that and has been developed locally and with the support of other school districts as well.

[06:54:25] We monitor. You always have to monitor, monitor, monitor, monitor what you expect. So we work a lot with our walkthroughs. Our walkthroughs place us in the schools. Our walkthrough process varies depending on what we're looking for.

[06:54:42] There are schools that, you know, we look for total alignment. You'll find our teams in the schools every day, every week. We monitor their walkthroughs for professional learning communities. We want to ensure teachers are planning. There are walkthroughs for high-quality instructional materials.

[06:55:01] We want to be sure the teachers are annotating properly and that they're taking time to internalize those lessons and teach those lessons the way they should be taught. So our walkthrough process is a tool that we actually adopted and adapted from the Office of School Quality.

[06:55:16] It was a work that we did when they first began to work with us. They were boots on the ground and held us accountable for these areas. And finally, the big rock around support. Student support cannot be undervalued.

[06:55:33] We appreciated the all-in plan money. We've written letters asking for more all-in plan money. We know that those dollars have been exhausted, but we're going to continue the plan anyway. We focused on attendance. Our chronic absenteeism was cut in half, reduced by half, because we were able to focus on those attendance plans.

[06:55:53] We know that tutoring matters. Oftentimes when you have parents of means, they hire tutors, they're able to take their children tutorial networks, we don't have that in Danville, so we pay tutors, we provide interventions during the day, because we still want our children to take advantage of the arts.

[06:56:15] the music. It's not fair to take away those programs, and our board believes in maintaining a rounded program, so we must pay our tutors and find ways on Saturdays. We have Saturday school that's been organized. Also, we cannot underestimate the impact of mental health and social-emotional needs of children, and we do pay a lot of attention and provide a wraparound model through that so if all that money comes back around we'll gladly take it uh if it doesn't we'll continue the work anyway we just want you to know that and so at this time i appreciate an

[06:56:55] opportunity to bring up principal extraordinaire mr mayo and then i'll close out okay all right thank you for allowing me this opportunity to present to you today just some of the components from our comprehensive school support plan um and how we got to where we are today at bonner middle school um we talked about strengthening the instruction one of the things we had to do was to focus on alignment we noticed that it took a long time to get us to where we're having teachers to look at the lesson plan look at the overarching standard to make sure that the standards that they

[06:57:33] were meeting the standard adjusting those standards and it took walkthroughs as dr harrison said earlier for us to walk and look at the classrooms we had iterative reliability walks where we had We had the district walk with the admin team, and we had teacher leaders to go into the classrooms and see if the teachers were breaking the standards down and making sure that the students were focused.

[06:57:53] We also asked the question, like, what is it? What is our focus? What do we want the students to know? How do we know that they know it? What are you going to do with those kids that didn't get it? And what are you going to do with those students that did get it? So those were all the components we put before the teachers every time. This is what we have to have.

[06:58:09] This was posted on our wall. It was our focus. We talked about data. we had data digs we started out with doing data digs every friday we had the teachers to sit in and they had to present their data and it was a collaborative effort because the grade levels all had to sit for every subject to see what the data looked like because johnny might be doing very well in english but in math he might be doing poorly so we will put some preventive measures in place to find out what it is that he's not getting in math let's look a little deeper dive deeper what is it is it a teacher and then we look at other teachers with similar students like that some of their kids were growing faster so then we allowed the time for teachers to get a

[06:58:48] chance to view each other they go in another classroom and do peer observation that was very impactful because teachers was like oh my god i didn't know that she did that i'm going to steal that idea so it became more of a not my self-centeredness but me working together collaboratively with everybody everybody started seeing that kids are all of our kids it's not just your students it's all about hey we're going to move this child send him to me i know how to teach that very well i'm going to do it in a small group setting so those things were done i also talked to dr harris and i said i want to have a data wall where we get a pulse of the school so we did put up all

[06:59:24] the standards on our poster making machine we had all the standards listed for math ela and science and we had the teachers to put their common assessment scores their benchmark scores provided by the district on a display we had color-coded system we had red for below basic we had yellow for almost there we had green for on target and blue was advanced and we had those scores up and when we walked into the room teachers started having like you know ownership like wow first they were reluctant about putting their name up there with their score composite score but then they were like wait this makes sense what did you do it caused dialogue conversation hey how did you

[07:00:04] get there let me see i want to see what you did share with me what you did so even though teachers work together collaboratively plan when it comes to implementing and instituting it and executing it rather it's a difference so that's why we allowed them the opportunity to observe each other so they could get that skill set that sometimes somebody else may be lacking um we also looked at intervention and remediation as dr harrison said we i i thank god for her she's a godsend tradition because she is a no-nonsense person.

[07:00:33] I mean, she's a driver, and it brings about change because, like you say, some people always want to know what it is that we can do to change. We have to change ourselves. So I pass that on to my staff like, look, let's look at what we're doing. What are we not doing? What can we do better?

[07:00:49] And so this became a trend throughout the school, and we were able to look at providing interventions. How many teachers are staying up in school to work with kids? You know, it's not just my kids. We have teachers that are teaching other kids after school. So we also monitor that.

[07:01:04] We had the admin team walk and look at what was happening during after school tutoring. Even though it's late in the evening, we still want to know, are you providing quality instruction? Are you doing stuff that's aligned to the standards? So those were key components that we had to monitor to make sure that we were following through with that.

[07:01:21] We also did small group instruction during the day. We did double dosing. There were times where we had the PE teacher say, hey, keep them 30 minutes. send him to me the next 30 minutes because he's behind in his mouth. We had opportunities for students that were sick. We had COVID. We had kids that were out with their flu. Just common things, sickness in the family, death in the family. You have a lot

of kids missing on days. So we, again, with Dr. Harrison's idea of implementing a Saturday school, we had kids going to Saturday school to get caught up. We had kids staying after to get caught up doing that meaningful engagement.

[07:01:51] And we also provided opportunities for students that were advanced to participate in chess club, to participate in a book club reading um and doing poetry and drama those were all things that they had to utilize their reading skills um to get better with um we talked about culture and climate our school we had a no-nonsense um climate where i think from the first year i got there to where we are now it's like night and day um and the ambiance when you walk into the school people always say oh my god it's so nice here we have music playing we have collaborative spaces that we've created where kids can go out and you trust them they go out there and work on a project

[07:02:30] they're out there in the commons area we have a big open area at our school where we have little tables and little whiteboards set up where they can work on projects together and it's it has an atmosphere that kids know that this is a place of learning so we really really take pride in that because i've seen and everybody in the district has seen the transition from where we started to where we are now um we have high expectations for those students because we have assembly meeting we tell students what we expect and then we model it and those kids that can't get it we pull them aside and do a small group session so let's model and show show you how we supposed to act in the hallway let's model and show you what the expectations are for doing your homework or assignments so those are things that we always want to do if they don't know we just can't take

[07:03:09] it for granted that they do we have to show them um we also do PBIS positive behavior intervention support recognition we try to start with the extrinsic rewards to get kids to understand hey you can do something great and just get something forward just because we have ice cream we give ice cream to the students um after school we we have cotton candy machine we do little bags of cotton candy for kids that make the honor roll or anything like that and then those things paper off and then it becomes you know intrinsic because we have kids monitoring their own data they're looking at plotting their data where they are i know how does effect tell us you know that kids do better

[07:03:45] when they know where they are and they plot their own data it's true because we have our kids to do that so that's very um i take pride in our kids understanding why they need to learn and and the purpose for it also teacher support pocs were implemented we started out the first years i was there you know poc was kind of shabby a little bit we got better and we understood that hey this is the process we set some norms and we went through the process of understanding what appeals they should be and what we should look for um coaching feedback cycles we talked about coaching the the instructional coaches as well as administrators work with teachers to provide support we tiered

[07:04:22] the teachers we cheered them into groups of level one two and three level one being um the great and three being not so great but we provided that support so we could retain teachers and keep them because we invested in our you know our teachers and the teachers become better we provide opportunities for them to go and see other teachers and we have a teacher a dynamic teacher somewhere else we would send that teacher there and then they would come back and talk about it what did you see? Trying to let them discover some of the things that we wanted them to see, and that had proven to be effective. Also, family and community partnerships. We did family night, we did math, science, ELA night, and they would have giveaways for students. We have also

[07:05:01] make it, take it stations where we would do stuff with the teachers and the parents, and they would get a chance to see what the standards entailed. This was an eye-opener for a lot of parents. I was like, wow, I didn't know that my kid was doing all this. This is hard. You know, so it was an eye-opening, and then they were understanding the need to bring those students to those events and let them attend to the after-school sessions if we needed to have them come.

[07:05:24] With all that being said, I think that the evidence of the impact was where we got to exiting from the CSI school status. We've improved the SOL scores in math and reading. We have narrowed the achievement gaps in our subgroups.

[07:05:40] We looked at that, and we're proud of that because we're constantly closing that. We're just digging deeper at individual children, looking to see where they are and seeing what gaps there are and providing those support pieces in place. So I thank you for allowing me to share that with you.

[07:05:55] Thank you. Okay. So our impact, I'll close with our impact slide. All these things are nice, but we have to demonstrate some movement. In 21-22, we didn't have Forest Hills and Galileo that were accredited with waiver.

[07:06:13] That meant that if they were accredited prior to COVID, they earned the accreditation, but we know that they had a couple of gap areas there. But by 24-25, we had our five schools that are listed there fully accredited under the old model.

[07:06:29] We know we're moving to a more rigorous model, but we were very proud to have those five schools accredited. Also, OT Bonner was removed from the CSI list, and we also had Activate, which is a program, three through seven programs serving almost 300 students that earn a STEM accreditation and accreditation through Cognia, which we believe in those standards as we work through improvement as well. So we are seeing real impact from these collective efforts. We see improved culture and climate this is the first year in 10 years that our school district entered the year

[07:07:08] fully staffed we did not have any vacancies when we opened school we're seeing increased student growth stronger engagement from our families and we remain deeply deeply um we deeply committed to continuous cool quality improvement and the work with the office of school quality actually held our feet to the fire and held us accountable for some things that we may have may have slipped by a little bit they really held us accountable so we are excited about the direction of danville public schools our partnership with uva again another set of eyes giving us a framework to

[07:07:46] operationalize our strategic plan and we're just excited and i'm excited because it's my hometown and i'm seeing seeing it move so we'll close there with any questions thank you i'm sure a lot of board members have things to say but i just want to say um mr mayo i am like i was in the classroom middle school for 10 years and i'd like to go back to the classroom and teach in your school awesome thank you um because seriously people do not i mean when you're in the classroom and you

[07:08:25] have a strong instructional leader that is coming behind you, really lifting you up, holding your hand, helping you to see how to better your craft, it makes you dig deep. And that, I mean, that is a clear marker for why you have no vacancies starting the year in the entire division. It speaks to both of your leadership it speaks to the leadership throughout the division it tells us here that you

[07:08:59] are doing the things that you need to do to move the needle in danville and truly i would be honored to come and visit your school and just see the excitement because i can only just hearing you

explain the things that you all have done makes me envision what's happening there with teachers and students every day you bring it truly to life in your explanation um and i my middle school teacher heart is so thankful for you so thank you so much thank you thank you thank you

[07:09:38] anyone yeah no i mean it really is i mean yeah y'all are just lucky i didn't start crying yeah it's all good it's all good i just want to say congratulations on exiting css status so i know that's huge for you guys you've made tremendous progress and i just want to say congratulations and um we know based upon the model that you set what other needs you have because i know you said of course if there's more money you would take it obviously but regarding specific needs you follow

[07:10:13] me like if it if it's electronic dashboard or anything like that i think it's important that we know what you really feel would help you out and we spoke to Mrs. Booker Dwyer early on last week I love your energy by the way your energy and your ideas and we spoke about the need to have better access to data and better dashboards across the state so we talked about that and I think she's looking at some ideas but that is the one area we need support Mr. Monk yes just

[07:10:49] congratulations kudos two quick questions you talked about high expectations for students and you had an assembly so i want to hear more about what the stu what that culture change looked like with that expectation shift and then i also heard you talk about students are tracking their own data and so help me understand you know as students are looking at that data you know are they monitoring that expectation that you have that new expectation yes okay yeah so we have more kids that are taking advanced courses now um for example we have um our eighth graders are all

[07:11:24] taking algebra one this year um we pushing them we got the parents to talk about the need and and we think they can do it we know they can do it and um we also have the they they have we have a data sheet where they have their standards there that they have to meet through the year and the teachers the students are able to shape the bar graph to show where they are and then they can take that portfolio with them to show hey i'm weak in this area i need to improve on that and then when they go to after school tutoring they know what they're working on the teacher that may not be their teacher in after school tutoring already know what they need to work on the teacher left you know we have a google doc where we share that with what they need to work on specifically and

[07:12:02] that helps everybody stay on target and then we come back and revisit that looking at the data we have so when we have a parent conference night our kids are able to present we do student-led conferences um as well those students are able to present with their parents so we have multiple sessions happen at the same time in the classroom the teachers just facilitate um and that helps a lot because we want kids to be able to share and then if the parent have specific questions at the end they can come and talk to the teacher before they leave but that is um the goal that we want to increase that more to do it to get more parents to come out to participate in that but that's really has been beneficial and the other thing with the culture shift change um we at the assembly

[07:12:41] meetings we talk to students and remind them that you are scholars we expect you to do great things i said students here if you have a conflict we give them resources where they can go if you have a conflict you can see any adult in the building go and meet that person we have people stand on guard when we change classes they're on duty teachers are greeting them my expectations that teachers in the morning send their doorway in the threshold and greet students every morning and that's what is

happening the kids are happy they're excited about learning we have had any suspensions thus far and i can remember the first year i got there we had a fight every other day

[07:13:16] i was like my god i have thrown my career away what have i done but um but it's totally different i'm telling you it's in the um like i said the collaborative spaces that we've had the district provided us some new furniture where we got things that they asked me what do you need what do you need and working with dr babelola and dr harrison they allowed me to pick out some things and i i felt valued because i had input and say so over it same thing i expect my teachers they have values they have input our leadership team they talk to us about things that they want things that they need to change or adjust and we listen and that's one thing i i'm a great listener i can get right down and help teachers i've done small group sessions they've seen me out there in the comments

[07:13:56] when it's time you know the review with i'm because i was a math teacher i'm right there working so all my team the coaches everybody jumped in all hands on deck i love it and uh i just get excited about it i'm sorry but um it's great and this i'm telling you this the school like i said with dr harrison coming in i can contribute all that never because she opened up and allowed me to have some autonomy or some things and i suggested things and asked for things and she got it she was like okay we're gonna get this and that's that's what i value because she has a heart for children and i know she does because she's in my building every other day she will pop in the back door she has

[07:14:35] a key to everything i was like oh she's here and we had a code i'll tell this we had a code like you know we would say that um the bronco is here the code i think she knows because they're walking they didn't turn the walking down but it's funny because she's always in and out so like she said earlier she inspects what she expects so there's no down time and as another person said stay ready you won't have to get ready so we stay ready so thank you dr harrison for doing that thank you

[07:15:07] i appreciate it anyone else okay good good job thank you so much um we're going to take a quick

[07:15:16] break um in five minutes and then we'll come back you had a family matter to attend to and

[07:26:15] we will try to keep the trains on the track with this these next two presentations and just for a spot check for the board and staff. We are going to defer items F and G until tomorrow. So we will wrap up here in this next 45-60 minutes with the items D and E. And we've got Tiara Booker-Guire on tap for both of them. So we will turn the time over to you and we'll, for everybody in your

[07:26:50] materials were turned item d perfect well i'm glad to be back i think uh danville and uva they they set up the next presentation wonderfully because this is all about uh the revised approach that we are taking to school and division support for student success and when you look at the next slide we really want to ground our approach in data and you heard the danville superintendent talk about you know using that data to drive instruction and we we want to get deeper with

[07:27:24] our data at the state level we want the quantitative data and the qualitative data because the numbers tell you one thing and people will tell you something else and you have to marry the two so that you can truly understand the strengths and the needs and the assets of the community and the divisions that we are supporting and so on the next slide it talks about the our statewide approach that we want to be very focused we want to collaborate with divisions we don't want to come and do something to a division we want to work in partnership with them so that it

[07:28:01] sustains and it's not just a compliance exercise and we want it built to last and so um so you see the bullet points that, you know, we're really grounding our work in data and customization. And when we talk about the data, so on slide five, we talk about the two types of assessment data.

[07:28:23] Every school division administers a local assessment. Those local assessments, those are those leading indicators, those just-in-time corrections for instruction to help improve student achievement. When the state assessment data comes out, now that data is lagging.

[07:28:39] looking at data from last school year, this school year, but that data is still actionable because it allows you to inform future planning. So you marry that local assessment data with the state assessment data to truly map that direction. And there's other data that we can also use, but that is what we are grounding our approach in. And the first presentation I did, we looked at, you know, this big bucket statewide data, which is great, and that's just the first cut, but you have to go deeper when we're talking about truly moving student performance.

[07:29:15] And we have a lot of tools that allow us to go deeper. And so when you look at slide seven, we look at, you know, how students perform statewide in math. What we can do is we can access reports such as this, where it has a reporting category, So a group of related skills, and it gives you kind of a snapshot of how students are performing.

[07:29:42] And the idea is that you want the students, you know, at least above the 40 mark here to say that, okay, they are, they have some strengths here. And when they're below that, then there's work to do. And so when you look for each of these categories, you could see that there's work to do.

[07:30:01] And we need to go even deeper because we need to know specifically what is that work. And so when we go deeper, divisions in schools, they can access a school detail by question summary report. And this is a deeper look at the data.

[07:30:18] And we have these reports for most of our assessments, not all of them, but like I'm showing you an Algebra I report from a school division. And this is what they see. And we're going to zoom in on slide nine, where you could see the item descriptor.

[07:30:36] So what was the content that the student did well on or did not do well on? The M means that the difficulty levels was at a medium range, L is low, H is high. And then when you look at the percent correct, you could see the percent correct for the division for that item descriptor on that particular test form from that bigger snapshot, and then the percent correct at the school level.

[07:31:04] And this is a powerful tool because it allows you to focus. If you see that, when you look at that, the last one, completely factor a polynomial, for instance, that school, 60%, got 60% of those questions correct.

[07:31:20] The division, not so much. And that's a lower level question. So that's something we could see what is that school doing and how can that be replicated across the division for this school? So this allows us to better focus the support that we provide to divisions.

[07:31:36] It allows the divisions to better focus the training and the support that they need to provide to teachers. So we're taking that big state data and we're starting to funnel it down to what students need to know and do. And that is what we're gonna use to drive our statewide support.

[07:31:56] We are gonna use that to help tailor our support for on specific content and skills. We can't do professional learning on everything. We don't have the capacity, But we pick those skills that we know those students struggled the most in to really help build the capacity of the teachers to facilitate that instruction, we could help move the needle.

[07:32:16] So we're going to really focus and tailor our support. And we want to bring educator prep programs at the table. We have to share this data with them. They are preparing teachers in Virginia, and they should know where students are struggling.

[07:32:32] And so when we get our data reports, we want to send that out. know we'll clean up any information that you know that would identify a particular student or teacher in it but we want to be able to say when you're preparing our math teachers this is where the students are struggling so you may want to double down on these areas we also want to invite our educator prep programs the faculty to our professional learning we want to be part in partnership with them so that we are also that they're hearing what you know the the state level work we can inform their practice they can inform our practice it's a collaborative partnership

[07:33:09] so we're looking at going deeper with our educator prep providers on slide 11 you'll see how parents and teachers can access these reports as well so every parent teachers you could see how students and how your child did on certain uh concepts and skills and once again you have that the hml high medium and low difficulty and if it's an x that means the student did not get that correctly they they need need a little bit more support there if it's a check then they did well and this once

[07:33:42] again allows you to begin to personalize the instruction the support for students and we are developing resources to help parents and educators understand what these reports are saying, we have some posted already, and how to use it to really inform instruction. And slide 12, I just wanted to highlight, there's a parent portal that every parent of a public school student could go into. Your division has, they have to give you that claim code, but you can pull your child's scores at any, well, once they're posted, you can pull them, and your child's scores from

[07:34:20] last year are posted now, and you can pull them and look at them, but your division needs to give you that claim code. And this is at no cost to parents, no cost to divisions, we pay for this. So we, this is a tool that we definitely want our parents to use. And when we're talking about customizing for success, in that org chart that was described, you know, we have a new office, we have excellence and best practices. We just hired an executive director who is going to go deep in the data to find those areas of best practices right here in Virginia and nationally.

[07:34:58] What could be replicated and how can we promote in that local innovation and replication? And so she is actively working on, I have her charged with developing a clear definition, clear criteria, so that when we go out and to look for best practices, everyone understands what we are talking about and um and we're looking deeply at our needs assessment process the monitoring process we're looking holistically at everything because when it comes to improving schools it's often it's a lot of factors that contribute and you and you can't focus on everything all at once

[07:35:35] and so how can we focus on what is going to what's going to move students um and get that quicker return on investment um while we're still focusing on the systemic planning and so we first want to to start with what got you in. That's what we need to focus on so we can help get you out. So when we think about our comprehensive support and improvement schools, we know that oftentimes they're

identified because of math and reading achievement. If we drill down to those skills that the students are really struggling with, let's focus on that and help to move our student improvement. And it's, you know, it's not that simple. It's a little bit more complicated than that, but we want to

[07:36:14] streamline the focus. And that is the overarching approach that we want to take. And we are also looking to collaborate in a much greater depth with our divisions. In conversations that I'm having with superintendents around the state, they really want a partner. They don't want something being done to them. It's all about partnership, not prescriptions. And so that's what we want to focus on. We want to have them at the table so that we are working together to help to improve

[07:36:47] their divisions and their schools. We're also looking at more flexibility with our ESSA plan, like how can we get more creative with how we're using some of those federal funds and the flexibilities that we're allowing for our school divisions. You heard the Danville superintendent it took five years for them to really move the needle.

[07:37:09] And so if every year you're turning around a plan and every year you have to redo everything over again, that can slow down process. So how can we really look at a five-year plan and work with them for a much longer and sustained time? So we're looking at that.

[07:37:26] I talked a little bit earlier about, we wanna go to the MOU divisions and really go deeper there with those division leaders. And when we, those schools for CSI and all the other federal designations, when they come out, we want to sit with the division leaders and really map out a plan because the goal is not for you to stay in this status.

[07:37:47] Now, the way that the federal designations are, there will always be a bottom 5%, but we don't want the same bottom 5% every, like you've got to show growth. And so that's what we want to work with our divisions on. And then when you go to slide 18 around, you know, we're talking about effective practices, context truly matters. You know, what works in Petersburg may not work in Lee County. And so we have to look at individual school divisions and the strengths that they have and what they bring

[07:38:21] to the table and their needs. So we're not just coming in with a deficit mindset. We know that something is working well here. Let's look and find that and let's see how we can use that to improve your needs. And then we want to maximize opportunities for students and really encourage divisions to take advantage of all of the great flexibilities and options that are offered in Virginia around virtual learning and all the advanced course options, reimagining teacher roles, you know, looking at career lattices and just innovative ways that you could position your

[07:38:59] most effective teachers to maximize the impact on students without putting 60 kids in a class and having one effective teacher. We want to make sure that how can we maximize that effective teacher to build the capacity of other teachers and still support student learning. And so with next steps, we are actively analyzing state assessment data to really pinpoint some focus areas for improvement. We are going through and we're thoroughly looking at our needs assessment, monitoring reporting grant process we are going through that and and we're looking at really

[07:39:37] partnering deeper with our school division leaders and higher ed and also bringing business and other stakeholders to the table because this improvement is um it's about really the state of virginia and so we can't do it on our own we really have to work together to make sure that we are preparing students who are going to contribute back to the state and um and yeah and so um we're focused on

creating those sustainable structures and so there's going to be a lot more to come around what we're doing in school improvement at future board meetings pause there and if there's any questions well thank you thank you very much and um just uh i'd actually just appreciate if you'd

[07:40:16] maybe just share a little bit maybe if some lessons learned in maryland or other places and maybe bringing some good practices or other things that you've learned otherwise and how they're integrated into this plan and so it's so one of the the big lessons that i learned um is you you know you really can't take the same approach with everyone and so while it's great to have this framework you have to have some flexibility in it because everyone may not need support and talent management they may have that down um they may need to double down on their academic focus or they may not they may need support with culture and climate so it's really about adjusting the

[07:40:53] approach so when you go in with that one size fit all solution um you you don't get that which it becomes this compliance exercise and so it's up and we have to have a team that's large enough to do that you will have a lot of school divisions here um and so we will actively be hiring and posting positions very soon uh to really help support that work because that's what you have to do and it's partnering with the superintendent it's partnering with the principal all the leaders have to be in alignment. I could remember rolling coaching out in Maryland. And what we found was that we were providing a coach, the division was providing a coach, they had a coach from a vendor, and the principal felt like I'm getting over coached. Too much support is actually hurtful.

[07:41:34] And so it's streamlining to make sure we're all on the same page. And so little things like that, I think, really helped move the needle here. Thank you very much. Any questions? So to your last point, I've been talking to a lot of folks around research practice partnerships, for instance. And one thing they tell me is that teachers don't want another thing to have to deal with, integrate. They want things to interface with what they already have in front of them.

[07:42:05] So for instance, we were talking about how do we get teachers to know more about evidence-based approaches, right? And they were telling me, like, don't expect them to go to a website. Don't expect, they're not going to do that. Integrate it into the LMS system that they're already using every day.

[07:42:21] Put it in the state standards document that they already interface with every day. So is there a possibility to use some of these structures that teachers are already using in LMS, for instance, to put some of these coordinated resources in their hands without having them to deal with another thing to go to and do?

[07:42:39] And that's where that customizing comes in. So we are currently developing customizable resources so that it can go to the division and they can customize it and put it into their system, use it how that division would use it, not how the state would use it.

[07:42:55] So us just rolling out, okay, do this, have this sheet, and this is how it should be done. It never works that way. It has to be authentic into what the teacher is doing in a natural part because no one can fit one more thing on their plate. Now, if something isn't going well, then they may need to take something off their plate.

[07:43:14] But that's what we are. That's a core part of our customized approach. Fair enough. Let me just push back a little bit. How many of our divisions are using Canvas? Do you know? Not off the top of my head. Okay. But we would work with the division for whatever, and they could put it in.

[07:43:33] So we wouldn't develop the Canvas thing. Sure. We could help frame it out, and then they could put it in and integrate it into their system. yeah, I'm not sure what the, I don't have a, my point was just that all, all divisions obviously don't have the same capacity to integrate these things stream, you know, in a streamlined fashion.

[07:43:50] So, but thank you. Any other questions? Deputy Superintendent, can you elaborate on some of the questions we've gotten in the last week of how you're thinking with the team about also supporting those divisions where they already do have a lot of proficient or advanced students? Right. So it is the expectation that if you are advanced I mean you know there is no ceiling here so you should keep going and there are opportunities for our advanced students so oftentimes what I see when we talk about school improvement you see divisions or school systems trying to close the

[07:44:27] achievement gap on the backs of advanced learners so you so and so what they do with advanced learners is okay now you tutor the the lower achieving student and you know there's nothing wrong with that I mean my daughter was a tutor and she loved it she felt like it helped her understand math even more um but they should get acceleration options as well so when we're thinking about um when we're looking at these numbers and i see 12 of the students are in it you know in advance i want to move that up we should be at 20 and next year we should be at you know 25 and 30.

[07:44:58] we our students should all be moving up um we we have to do more for our advanced learners hey well thank you and um we will move on to item e on defining proficiency yes so we talked a lot today and i'm calling up um two of our our partners uh who will come up and they will introduce themselves right before they present i'll get us teed up um we talked about you know

[07:45:37] when you're raising expectations for students and you are preparing um you you're given you know a more rigorous tests and your more rigorous standards you have to have more rigorous cut scores as well and um and just to so that we're all talking saying the same thing the cut score it determines the minimum score a student must achieve to reach a certain performance level so you're advanced you're proficient um uh fail or basic so i uh identified in the table on slide

[07:46:09] to our current performance levels and then what you see on slide three is that cut scores they were lowered in 2020 and so in back in 2013 you if you look at where the proficient and advanced levels were and then a decision was made November 2020 to lower the cut scores and so when you lower expectations for the students they're going to meet that expectation you raise the expectation students will they will work to meet it and so um so it was lower cut scores and then uh and you

[07:46:48] and we and what happened was so this chart on page four the blue line is where virginia's proficiency cuts are and the purple dots are the nape proficiency cuts and you could see there's a gap there so it shouldn't we shouldn't be surprised when students are not performing well on the nape assessment because we are not setting them up to do that there's a there's a proficiency gap there and um that next slide talks a little bit more about that honesty gap so in 2024 uh grade four 73 percent of our kids were proficient in reading and then you know our fourth graders and select

[07:47:26] fourth graders uh take the nape proficient um proficiency exam and it's only 31 and so there's this gap there that we want to close to ensure that Virginia students are meeting national benchmarks and that they are prepared to read well, write well, and to engage in math in a much deeper fashion. And so some of the actions that were taken prior to me coming here were the content standards were strengthened. And so what you see on this on slide six is the grade three standard

[07:48:04] for language usage for grade three and a grade three standard in 2024. And so what you'll see is that in 2017, the standard was a little lower. It was just, you're going to edit writing. You're going to have capital letters, punctuation. Now, students, you have to use the conventions of standard English when speaking and writing. You have to differentiate between contexts that calls for formal english and informal english um and so you and then it goes into all the different um

[07:48:39] the items that students have to do and you could see the increase in what students are required to know the performance level descriptors were increased in 20 um in 2025 so in for the grade for reading in 2020 they had to identify you look at the you know it's low level verbs when you go to grade four 2025 you're describing you're summarizing you're analyzing explicit and implicit so in 20 and just to give you an example of what this looks like in 2020 you're identifying someone

[07:49:15] has on a green shirt in 2025 you are identifying they have on a green shirt you're speculating as so why would they have on a green shirt now notice that everyone outside was wearing a green shirt and i and so you have to take it a little bit deeper than just i see one person with a green shirt on and so um it's they're required to do a little bit more and then on slide eight what you'll see is that um you know some math problems and students at one point were required to demonstrate the one skill set to demonstrate that they were proficient in grade three um and now

[07:49:50] they have to do that question one plus question two to demonstrate proficiency so it's not just this um you know we've we've increased the standards but we're expecting them to know more to do more and so the the last step is the cut scores because if we set the cut scores too low then what we're saying is that you know we're setting low expectations you set them too high well now you're putting it out of reach for anyone and they could they could feel like we'll never make that and just give up so you need that right cut score where you're communicating high

[07:50:28] expectations coupled with the support to get them there so that so that students can demonstrate true proficiency we do have so a chat slide 10 has the computer adaptive test items and i'm going for this one i am going to bring up our partner and she's going to introduce herself and talk a little bit about the computer adapted test and the method for how we came up with the cut scores hi everyone i'm maryann perry with measurement practice and i've

[07:51:05] been working with our superintendent board chair governor since march to help with this ideal of raising rigor in virginia and raising the cut scores so i also got the pleasure of being at the standard setting workshop for the entire work working with both reading and math educators and community members and i want to give you a little bit of a briefing about what happened there but But before we go there, what we want to do is just ground you a little bit and reminder about what the test is and the fact that we have a computer adaptive test. And what that means is

[07:51:37] no child takes the same exact number or same exact item set. We have a bank with lots and lots of items at different difficulty levels. And students start with one, they answer it correctly, they get a harder one. Student next to them answer it wrong, they're going to get an easier one. And it's going to keep adapting to where the student is. And what it starts with is large leaps. And then the leaps get smaller and smaller and smaller. The computer programs say the student is right here.

[07:52:05] This is where their ability level is. So it's a very nice way to assess students. It gives us a more precise reading. In less time, it tends to frustrate students less because they don't get items that they have no idea how they even approach, nor do they get items that they're just bored with and just want to get this

over with. We're trying to tailor right out where they are. But what that means is there's really no purpose of talking about percent correct.

[07:52:32] Because it's not percent correct. It's which items you got right and how hard were they? And so you're going to see us talk in terms of the scale scores that Deputy Superintendent showed us. So I do want to remind you, we have done a lot.

[07:52:48] I was here in May and talked to you about the process and what we were going to do. And then we went in and we did it. We had our standard setting meeting. We prepared a briefing for you for your June meeting. So that was a written report where we went through who showed up, what qualifications they had, what kind of reactions did they have to the meeting.

[07:53:09] And I just will say, wow, what a fantastic group of educators and community members working collaboratively as a committee. There was definitely a little bit at the beginning where the community members are like, well, maybe I don't know enough. And the teachers are like, what are they doing here? And they worked together and they talked so well and really respected each other and had wonderful collaboration.

[07:53:31] I kind of wish everybody could be a fly on the wall for these meetings because it's just invigorating to listen to them talk. So the stuff that the deputy superintendent has already shown you about should the items be more rigorous, should the PLDs be more rigorous. We had done some of the work before standard settings and the teachers kept going and said, we want to make this even more.

[07:53:50] So we want to add this when this is the kind of item we want kids to be able to answer. So they were just absolutely phenomenal. So I do want to just real quickly talk about the process because I know we've got a couple of new members here. I know we have previous board presentations that go into ad nauseum depth for those who want it. But we use something called the ID matching process.

[07:54:18] I stands for item and D stands for descriptor, which is this performance level descriptor we've been talking about. And it works really well with this cat because we don't need to have a fixed form. We can pull a sample of items. And we did. We pulled a sample of items across the scale, easy to hard. And you ask the teacher, what do you have to know and be able to do to answer this question correctly? And every teacher can tell you, well, you need to know this and you need to find the simplest form, blah, blah, blah. Okay. So when I look at the performance level descriptors for basic, proficient, advanced, which does this most likely match? And they literally just sit

[07:54:53] there and match the items to the descriptors. So it's a very teacher-friendly method because were asking them to use their expertise to do what they do every single day. And we were very careful in bringing in community members that also had this kind of content expertise, so they were not lost during this section.

[07:55:11] They kept right with us, kept working with us, and we would have discussions with the members about when you have disagreements, let's talk through why do you think it matches basic and you think it matches proficient, let's talk that through. And then as you see, you can see as they go through, they find that transition point.

[07:55:27] here is where items are transitioning from basic to proficient so therefore here is where the cut score goes um sorry i'm having a hard time reading this little tiny screen make sure i'm not skipping

anything good nope okay uh so slide 12 13 excuse me one of the things i want to talk about with the process is panelists went through three rounds just within their group so a group of grade three

[07:56:01] reading educators and community members sat down for a day and a half round one do this talk to each other round two talk to each other round three done then we selected two to three people from each room to all go into one big room and do what's called vertical articulation and that's when third grade gets to talk to fourth grade and say well where did you set the rigor and is it in the right place or do we need to make adjustments so that happened and what we're presenting today as the result of that last meeting, where they landed. And the really nice thing is someone who deals with numbers all the time was watching the committee really kind of coalesce around the

[07:56:41] median. We always use the median. We always tell panelists, every single one of your opinions is important. We want you all to tell me what you really think, where you think the cut score should go, but I'm going to take the median as the recommended cut score. So they know that going in. And as we work through it, the numbers start getting closer to the median. And the median may change from round to another, but there tends to be less variance over time as they really start coalescing around agreeing where the cut score should go. I will say for this committee in reading, the advanced cut score had the most agreement. They were very clear on where advanced should be.

[07:57:14] And so when it got to vertical articulation, when it got to the point where they were bringing in people across the rooms to talk to each other, there was very little change. So in reading, we only changed grade five proficiency and, of course, reading advanced. Those were the only ones they looked at and said, these feel a little out of line with the adjacent grades. We want to adjust them to make them more like the adjacent grades. Slide 14. So this is a new way for Virginia to be looking at the cut scores. So Virginia's got an interesting history of since 1998, when you first

[07:57:49] scaled the test, they scaled it saying proficient is 400, advanced is 500. So we can say, so right now, the 2020 cuts, right now it's 400 and 500. But we can look at that scale and look at it forwards and backwards and say, well, if we use today's scale, what would the number have been then? What would the numbers be in the future? So what you're seeing on slide 14 is today's scale, so 2020 proficient's 400, advanced is 500. It was set that way. And what it would have been if we had that scale back in 2013. Anybody who's confused and said, I taught in 2013 and the scale was still

[07:58:25] 400 and 500. Yes, it was. But this is pushing everything onto one common scale. And that's how we can see that as Deputy Superintendent talked about, the cut scores dropped in 2020. And now the recommendation coming straight out of the committee is to raise them quite significantly.

[07:58:44] So the way to read that is what 400 in grade three reading. Right now, 400 is proficient. They recommend that proficiency be raised to 444 on that current scale. So if you look at the next slide, what they did is they brought this rigor back up to NAIT proficiency. So they did what was asked of them by going through this method of batching item knowledge and skills to performance level descriptors. So what you're looking at, again, is that pinkish purple dot is where the

[07:59:20] NAIT proficiency cut would be on the Virginia scale and where the Virginia proficiency cut that they recommended should be. And that vertical line is a standard error of measurement. So what that's telling you is that within 67% likelihood, these numbers are about the same.

[07:59:36] So they are statistically equivalent. The cut scores they recommended are statistically equivalent to NAEP cut scores. Can you maybe just give us a couple of examples of other states and their alignment with the NAEP standards, maybe some of the best practices that are out there?

[08:00:00] Yes, so other states have, it's common for states to want to align with NAEP because when your students take the NAEP assessment, you don't want to see that drop. You don't want to see that big gap. And so it's not just about just aligning with NAEP, but it's also about giving that support to bring students up.

[08:00:24] And so when Tennessee did this, they aligned, you know, they saw a drop in their student performance. And it's, and I think we can overcome that by doing this in a more strategic way and taking some lessons learned from the states who, who did that.

[08:00:43] And I'm not saying anything negative against those states, but we want to learn from what they did so that we don't do that and we can modify that approach. So that's about like rolling out support. we could think about a different type of rollout of the cut score.

[08:01:01] So you keep the cut scores the same, but the students who are responsible for meeting that score at a certain time may change, but we're not changing that proficiency. Proficiency is still here, but we wouldn't want to impact graduation of a student this year.

[08:01:17] That wouldn't be fair to the student. And so there's all kinds of things that we could do to support the state to move students toward the proficiency level, it doesn't have to happen overnight. It's about a systemic effort and having everyone understand the higher expectations, and you've got to start with the principals and the teachers and the division leaders so that they can understand what needs to happen to move students there.

[08:01:41] Parents can understand, and then we can get there, but it has to be thoughtfully done and systemically rolled out in a way that's bringing the superintendents along with us. - Thank you. I probably should have waited until you're done of presentations. I'll slap my own wrist. So what I was just talking about was reading and I want to do the same thing with mathematics. So again, going back to slide 16, same sort of thing happened. Great committee. They coalesced around a median. They were very much in agreement on

[08:02:17] advanced. And then we brought them together for vertical articulation to say, okay, third grade, talk to fourth grade, talk to fifth grade. Do these look right across the grades? And one of the things that we found was the grade three math committee went pretty high in their recommendations.

[08:02:33] So we actually had to adjust grade four up and grade four, three down in proficiency to get them a little bit more aligned with each other. Basic cut scores in grade four and five were increased a bit and grade four advanced was also increased a bit. So again, very few changes when you think about three through eight is sixth grade levels times three cut scores. So there's 18 things they could have changed, and I think they changed 1, 2, 3, 4, 5. So a lot of agreement there. So slide 17 then shows what these cut scores look like on today's scale. So again, a grade 3 math proficient

[08:03:10] today is 400. Back in 2013, it was a 421. Many recommended it to be a 443. And again, the next slide 18 shows how well the math committee did in bringing our rigorous expectations up to align with the rigor of NAEP. So they did not see these graphics as they were working through this. This was something we created afterwards, but wow, they do a great job. So a question that often arises after a standard setting meeting is say, okay, well now what? What do we do when I sat down and

[08:03:48] met with the superintendent? What do we do with these cut scores? And so Chris Tomolewski, who's on your technical advisory committee, is going to talk about those steps. Thank you. My name is Chris Tomolewski. I'm with a group called the National Center for the Improvement of Educational assessment. I've had the pleasure of connecting with some of the board members before. It's nice to connect with those who I haven't met before now. As Dr. Perry mentioned, I represent Virginia's Technical Advisory Committee, and my role here is to provide some reflections on what kinds of

[08:04:27] decisions may be appropriate in light of the information that's been shared heretofore. So the question that we've used to frame this is, how do we know if the standards are right? And And I've, I think from my earliest interactions with the board for some time ago, I mentioned that really the credibility of these decisions resides in the process.

[08:04:47] And you heard Dr. Perry talk about the process, that it is research-based. It certainly was implemented with fidelity. It had all of the characteristics and features that we talked about early on as being so important as characteristics of a robust and defensible standard setting process.

[08:05:02] So it's very gratifying to see that a strong design was in place and that it was implemented really well. And in fact, one of my colleagues on the TAC, Dr. Denny Way, was at the TAC, excuse me, at the standard setting workshop along with Dr. Perry. And you see him pulled a quote from his report there on slide 19, where he certainly expresses strong confidence in the methods and implementation that he was able to observe during that time. So very pleased to be able to report that the standard setting was a strong design and implemented really well. Even with a strong

[08:05:36] process you may want to ask is an adjustment appropriate and you may also want to reflect is that within the range of professionally accepted practices at a time like this and um you know the reason it's before the board now the reason we're talking about it is that this is an intersection of technical and policy there is absolutely a policy dimension to this which is why it's before the board and we know that even with a strong process it's quite common for state leaders to make adjustments to make sure that their policy priorities are fully honored. In the best case, that occurs in a way that really honors the process and intent that gave rise to the standards

[08:06:16] that you're looking at now. So you may decide to make an adjustment that may be appropriate to better reflect your policy. If you do decide, I would propose that professional practice suggests that it would be within a small range of uncertainty. You heard Dr. Perry mentioned the standard error that is one way in which we would advise you consider a range for an adjustment standard error just simply reflects if a student were to take a test on multiple occasions you'd see sort of a pattern of results cluster around a certain range and standard error it's a statistical estimate of what that range is so it's very commonly used at a time like this

[08:06:55] to consider what kinds of adjustments are considered within the intent of the standard interested panelists and what may be further from those recommendations. And so you see, I just have two more slides and I'll be very succinct here. We think there's two options to consider. Option one, very simply, is not to make an adjustment. The board may decide to adopt the panel's recommendations without any further adjustments. You may decide to do that insofar as it directly reflects the recommendations of the committee. However, doing so may not fully honor the board's policy priorities to close the honesty gap. You may still find that there are some areas that

[08:07:33] would benefit from tweaking in order to make sure that your policy priorities are reflected. And another limitation of that approach is that there may be a lack of consistency or coherence that you would want to smooth out or that you would want to address. So there's not every grade content area may reflect the same um pattern of rigor that the board would desire to uh to endorse superintendent yes chris so just in case people aren't looking at our fabulous slides

[08:08:08] when you say option one is no adjustment you are not saying keep proficiency where it is instead you are saying adopt the panel's recommendation without further adjustments to actually change proficiency and reset it. That's correct. To align to the high expectations.

[08:08:27] That's correct. And accept it as is as a result of the process. Yes, Dr. McPherson. Yes, so as it relates to we have the difference between the superintendent's recommended changes and we have the panel's recommendation, correct? So it's those two options. So I thought sometime before we were going to actually administer the test once we got the process completed and we were going to see

[08:09:04] where all schools were as it related to the new test okay um and i know i'm jumping a little bit madam secretary but do we have a date for when you're planning to do that i i heard um an assistant superintendent indicate that we didn't want to interrupt current 12th graders that are preparing to graduate you know who already have careers in mind maybe have been accepted by colleges and these things could impact but i think as it relates to what tests we're going to administer or how

[08:09:42] long we have to play with two options i'd like to know currently when are we planning to have the first experimental run i'm going to call it experimental run with the with the new test new testing superintendent i believe yeah i believe the deputy superintendent could address that yeah also if i could i think we have about a five minute high sign for uh building exit purposes so i don't want to yeah i would like to make sure though that we've got the expertise and the

[08:10:16] recommendations here and then we as a board can talk about uh tomorrow so else i i was pretty much completely with my remarks i was just going to say the second option was a small adjustment within the standard area, which I teed up well. So this is a good transition point to turn it back to the deputy superintendent to give voice to the department's recommendations. Thank you, Chris.

[08:10:36] Right. And that's the idea is that the superintendent is requesting to keep most of the recommendations from the committee, but then to modify the score, make some minor adjustments so that we are closer aligned to NAEP and that we are holding our advanced students to the same expectations of rigor because when you look at the when you compare so on that next slide you'll see the highlights where the superintendent's recommendations differ from the committee

[08:11:10] recommendations and a lot of those highlights yes and a lot of those highlights are in the advanced column and then the increase in the proficient column it closes that you know you that purple dot and that blue line and, you know, the standard of error bar that Dr. Perry talked about, it gets it closer so that we are in tight alignment with NAEP. And the idea is that we would roll this out with support. We wouldn't just say, here are the cut scores, good luck. It's about how are we going to support students to meet those higher expectations. So it would be a very

[08:11:49] thoughtful approach um to this uh if the board chooses to adopt that option too it wouldn't just be this is gonna um tomorrow seniors and of course assessments you better meet this high bar and you know and we can you know we can use mathematical modeling to predict how students would do but i

don't think that it would serve us justice because it doesn't factor in the supports that would be provided and how we're going to work with school divisions and um and what's already happening now to advance student learning there's been a lot of work around high quality

[08:12:22] instructional materials and we're about to do a lot with math so um and so the the the goal is really do you want the higher expectations to align with nape um then if that's the case then we can do that and we can provide all the support to get students and divisions there um so it's it's really a board decision thank you and just before we um i i just really do want to thank dr Perry and Dr. Domolesky and Tierra, just the process, the rigor, the involvement of all of those

[08:12:59] involved. I just, the point that you brought us today is just very, very helpful and just want to, on behalf of the board, thank you very much for your work. And I think we have a minute or two, maybe one or two questions, but I just wanted to, before we get cut off, I just wanted to thank you for getting the table set so that we can do what we need to do as a board so dr fullix on if you have anything else to okay no we've got time for a few questions now and then we'll cover this more

[08:13:31] on item tomorrow okay any questions i just want to make sure i fully answered your questions you asked about if the when are the new assessments and all that so the the assessments that students took last year um items that were low level were removed they had harder assessment items and so So, you know, so you could predict and, you know, you could do that kind of modeling now, but it's not taking into account everything that we would wrap divisions with and the funding that we would support and the professional learning and everything else to ensure that they are prepared to meet these cut scores.

[08:14:08] So do you have an estimation of when you think? I mean, are you talking next school year or school year after? It's the biggest concern of the board has always been that the students have been not meeting the expectations and that we want to raise the bar.

[08:14:25] so we you know we're torn between the fact we don't have a whole lot of time we constantly have students that are having difficulty we got to send the support we got to do what's necessary we got to figure out where the issues are as quickly as possible so the administration of the tests in my mind how we decide on a policy of how it really is going to count but knowing where they are based upon all of the new scores are going to be is is going to be very important on how we develop a

[08:15:02] policy going forward as to when you know this is the drop dead date this is the expectation we put in place some support so that's what my concern is trying to understand the rollout because you had a you know we've prepared a lot but at some point we've got to figure out where the problems are. And going deeper into the data to see specifically the concepts, the content and skills, that school improvement approach, that data approach is all going to help with that so that we could help get our students there quicker. Right. And in terms of teacher prep, I'm interested

[08:15:39] in knowing whether or not the teachers have ever been tested at a certain level on the materials so that we know whether or not their proficiency is where it needs to be. I mean, whether it's a sampling, testing, or whatever, but because we really want to drill down to figure out where the problems are, I think somebody should give some consideration to not just teacher prep and resources, but teacher testing so that we know that they really have the skill set. Thank you,

[08:16:12] Dr. McPearson. I think that's actually a good note to end on as we've got to transition to our deliberations, but just, again, thank you, and thank you all for your support to the board and the

department and with that more to come tomorrow and we will adjourn until nine o'clock tomorrow morning thank you

